

Multivariate Mement Problems and the Gaussian Radon Transform

Jasper Liáng Toman-Yih, Ph.D.
University of Connecticut, 2026

ABSTRACT

Put your abstract here. Try to use as little symbols as possible. This abstract will be typeset for web publishing and various databases (not by you), and symbols don't transfer well.

Multivariate Mement Problems and the Gaussian Radon Transform

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M.A. Mathematics, SUNY Potsdam, Potsdam New York 2019

A Dissertation
Submitted in Partial Fulfillment of the
Requirements for the Degree of
Doctor of Philosophy
at the
University of Connecticut

2026

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2026

APPROVAL PAGE

Doctor of Philosophy Dissertation

Multivariate Mement Problems and the Gaussian Radon Transform

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

At this point, I would like to thank the many people who - directly or indirectly or incorrectly - have contributed to this dissertation.

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NOTATION

(This section should be for reference only and most of these symbols should be defined in the text)

First recall the conventional multiindex notation. Let $\mathbb{N}_0$ denote the nonnegative integers. A multiindex $\alpha = (\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \dots, \alpha_n) \in \mathbb{N}_0^n$ is an n -tuple of nonnegative integers. The degree of a multiindex is $|\alpha| = \alpha_1 + \alpha_2 + \dots + \alpha_n$. Multivariate exponentiation is defined as follows. For $x = (x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n) \in \mathbb{R}^n$,

$$x^\alpha = x_1^{\alpha_1} x_2^{\alpha_2} \dots x_n^{\alpha_n}.$$

Here we will use the convention $0^0 = 1$ so that for example $(x, y, z)^{(0,1,0)} = y$. We will use $e_i \in \mathbb{R}^n$ to represent the canonical unit vector

$$e_i = (0, \dots, 0, 1, 0, \dots, 0)$$

which can also be interpreted as a multiindex so for example

$$(x, y, z)^{2e_1+e_3} = x^2 z$$

The multinomial formula gives a convenient expansion for multinomial powers. Let $k \in \mathbb{N}_0$. Then

$$(b_1 + b_2 + \dots + b_n)^k = \sum_{|\alpha|=k} \binom{k}{\alpha} b^\alpha$$

where the multinomial coefficients are defined

$$\binom{k}{\alpha} = \frac{k!}{\alpha_1! \alpha_2! \dots \alpha_n!}.$$

Note that the multinomial expansion sums over all multiindices $\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n$ of degree k .

We denote the standard euclidean inner product

$$\langle x, y \rangle = x_1 y_1 + x_2 y_2 + \dots + x_n y_n$$

where $y = (y_1, y_2, \dots, y_n) \in \mathbb{R}^n$ and the Euclidean norm

$$\|x\| = \sqrt{x_1^2 + x_2^2 + \dots + x_n^2}$$

We may slightly abuse notation by using the inner product and norm in different

dimensions, even in the same equation. This can be excused if one views each euclidean space $\mathbb{R}^n$ as embedded in the sequence space $\ell^2(\mathbb{R}^{\mathbb{N}})$ in which the inner product and norm are equivalent.

When discussing hyperplanes in $\mathbb{R}^n$ we index them by a unit normal vector, $\omega \in S^{n-1}$, and distance from origin $-\infty < p < \infty$, and we write for example the implicit hyperplane equation $\langle x, \omega \rangle = p$. Note that $\langle x, -\omega \rangle = -p$ represents the same hyperplane. It is perhaps more correct, in later defining the Radon and Gaussian Radon transforms, to identify these indexes and define the transforms over a projective space. We omit this discussion as it is not relevant within the scope of this work.

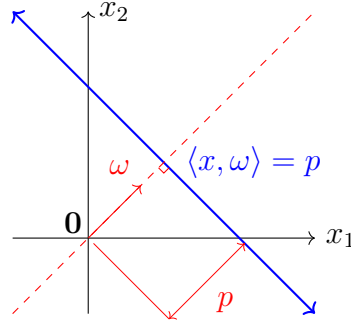


Figure 0.0.1: Hyperplane equation

fig:HypEq

Unless otherwise indicated all measures are Euclidean measures, that is the Borel measure associated with the standard Euclidean metric on a given space. In particular the Euclidean measure on a hyperplane of $\mathbb{R}^n$ is equivalent to the Euclidean measure on $\mathbb{R}^{n-1}$. We chose for convenience to denote measures by their associated variable such as dx , dp , dz , and others. It should be stated that this notation, while uniform, is context dependent. For example in the integrals

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^n} dx \quad \text{and} \quad \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = p} dx,$$

the measure dx is to be understood as the n -dimensional and $(n-1)$ -dimensional Euclidean measure respectively.

Introduction

0.1 TO DO

- To write:
 - Document. Fix bibliography
 - Intro. More formulas in intro.
 - Moments. Prove (again, better): Determinacy result for gaussian weighted L2.
 - Moments. Find good reference for terminology and history.
 - GF/M. Define Hermite polynomials, uni- and multi-variate.
 - GF/M. Prove determinacy from Rodrigues formula
 - RT/GRT. Define RT/GRT on distributions (See Helgason or Gelfand). Discuss: do these extended definitions satisfy the same purpose as the GRT? If so then what is the advantage of the GRT?
 - RT/GRT. Slice theorem: connect sufficient conditions to Fubini conditions.
 - RT/GRT. Work on notation for Gaussian measure. In particular w and ω are too similar.
 - RT/GRT. Search for references on G projection moments etc
 - RT/GRT. Expand background, historical context, etc...
 - Moments. Prove: Bounded regions are uniquely determined by moments? Maybe fits in RT/GRT since it can be formulated in terms of RT.
 - Implementation. Output some figures from Mathematica. For example sample points, moment tables, and reconstructions.
 - Example. Try to prove the conjecture (RT Hermite)
 - Split Ch2 in half: Theory and application.
- To research:

- Everywhere (ongoing). Provide examples for $n = 2, 3$ of as many results as we can.
- GRT. Domains of definition, i.e. $GRT : L^2 \rightarrow L^2$ and such.
- GRT. Integration by parts formula for GRT of $\partial f / \partial x_i$ (found dR/dp and thus dGR/dp)
- GRT. Verify the conjecture for $n = 3$
- GRT. Prove the conjecture on GRT of Hermite polynomials.
- Try to derive GRT of monomials from Hermite polynomials.
- Mathematica. Implement Gaussian shape reconstruction method, try some example shapes. Clearly lay out the choices made: Series of expanding images, or compactified $\mathbb{R}^n$? How to complexify points?

0.2 Shape Reconstruction

The shape reconstruction method: In a 2005 paper, Annie Cuyt et. al. ^[Cuyt05] ~~[9]~~ proposed a method for shape reconstruction from moments, via Pade approximants to a multidimensional integral transform. Given a set of multivariate moments of some region A in $\mathbb{R}^n$, the method produces a pixel image approximating A .

Suppose $A \subset \mathbb{R}^n$, and let $f(x)$ be its indicator function. We may assume f is measurable and has bounded support, and thus finite moments. The moment sequence gives Taylor coefficients in a neighborhood of zero for a certain holomorphic function with integral representation

$$g(y) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} \frac{f(x)}{1 + \langle x, y \rangle} dx \approx \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n} \binom{|\alpha|}{\alpha} c_\alpha (-y)^\alpha.$$

Thus the function $g(y)$ may be approximated to a certain degree of accuracy depending on the number of available moments.

At the same time g can be approximated by a multivariate quadrature formula

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^n} \frac{f(x)}{1 + \langle x, y \rangle} dx = \sum_i \frac{1}{1 + \langle x_i, y \rangle} f(x_i) = \sum_i w(x_i, y) f(x_i)$$

Where the nodes x_i lie, for example, on a cubic lattice. We can then sample a Pade approximant to g at some sufficiently large group of points $y = y_j$ forming a linear system of equations, from which we solve for $f(x_i)$. If all goes well we have approximations of $f(x_i)$ on a node lattice, which can be turned into a pixel image of A .

For now we will gloss over the numerical discussion of quadrature and linear systems, taking for granted that such methods are applicable in at least some simple

cases. Computational tests (to be included in, say, section 10) further support the validity of the method. Our focus will be on demonstrating that one can approximate g by rational Padé approximants constructed from moments. To this end we show that, when restricted to one dimensional subspaces, g is equivalent to the Stieltjes transform of the Radon transform of f at a fixed projection angle.

$$g(z\omega) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{R_f(\omega, p)}{1 + zp} dp$$

where $\omega \in S^{n-1}, z \in \mathbb{R}$. Thus we are able to leverage the more well understood properties of these univariate transforms.

In particular, the “projection moments” of $R_f(\omega, p)$ in any fixed direction ω , may be computed from the multivariate moments of f . Further, it can be shown that Padé approximants to a moment sequence converge to the Stieltjes transform, and thus to g . Returning to shape reconstruction, it then follows that one can approximate g at various sample points $y_j = z_j\omega_j$ via Padé approximants on linear subspaces at a selection of angles ω , as is needed to form our linear system.

Now let us briefly discuss our proposed modification to the shape reconstruction method, the theoretical complications and computational considerations. Essentially what we propose is to recreate the method with a Gaussian measure applied, thus allowing for convergence on a larger class of regions A . In particular, the proposed method would apply to unbounded regions, for which we cannot guarantee finite moments, convergence of the function $g(y)$ (let alone the explicit series expansion in terms of moments), or convergence of the Radon transform.

Here we will briefly discuss the potential challenges that this proposed method presents, which we address more carefully in sections 5 through 8. First and foremost instead of the standard moments (with respect to the Lebesgue measure), we are now given a Gaussian moment sequence — that is, moments with respect to the standard Gaussian measure on $\mathbb{R}^n$. On the other end, the reconstructed region may be recovered as normal by simply inverting the Gaussian weight.

From a theoretical standpoint, proving the validity of the proposed method presents a few challenges. Firstly, even a quick glance at the classical literature tells us that moment problems on bounded domains are substantially better behaved than their unbounded counterparts. Whereas all moment problems on a bounded interval are determinate, we now have the potential to run in to indeterminate problems. We show that we can guarantee determinacy in a Gaussian-weighted L^2 completion of the space of polynomials. This of course includes our primary use case: indicator functions.

Secondly, we must address the effect of the proposed modifications on the Radon transform. We will define the Gaussian Radon transform, which unlike the Radon transform exists for unbounded regions A .

The Stieltjes transform on unbounded domains is significantly more complicated than the original case. From the integral representation

$$g(y) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} \frac{f(x)}{1 + \langle x, y \rangle} dx,$$

one can start to see a problem: If $f(x)$ has unbounded support $g(y)$ has the potential to not converge for any $y \in \mathbb{R}^n$. In particular $g(y)$ may not exist in a neighborhood of 0, meaning our series expansion and thus the explicit connection to moments, may be broken. We need now to consider g as a function on some non-real domain. Here we show Pade approximants can be computed from moments which still approximate g on, for example, a half space. The convergence of these approximants is tied to the question of determinacy of the moment problem, which we resolve as described above. Thus we simply take sample points avoiding the problematic real space and the method is validated.

Chapter 1

Background

chap:background

sec:notation

1.1 Basic Notation

First recall the conventional multi-index notation. Let $\mathbb{N}_0$ denote the nonnegative integers. A multi-index $\alpha = (\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \dots, \alpha_n) \in \mathbb{N}_0^n$ is an n -tuple of nonnegative integers. The degree of a multi-index is $|\alpha| = \alpha_1 + \alpha_2 + \dots + \alpha_n$. Multivariate exponentiation is defined as follows. For $x = (x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n) \in \mathbb{R}^n$,

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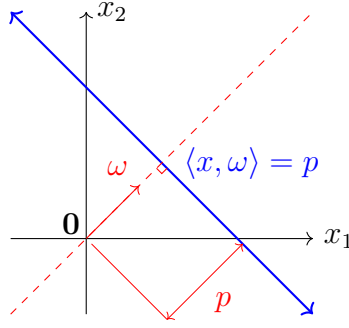


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$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^n} dx \quad \text{and} \quad \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = p} dx,$$

the measure dx is to be understood as the n -dimensional and $(n-1)$ -dimensional Euclidean measure respectively.

1.2 Classical and multivariate moment problems

Let μ be a Borel measure on $\mathbb{R}$. For $k \in \mathbb{N}_0$, define the k th moment of μ as

$$c_k = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x^k d\mu(x)$$

provided the integral converges. The sequence $(c_k)_{k \in \mathbb{N}_0}$ is called a moment sequence or a moment problem, and the measure μ is called a solution to the moment problem. Loosely speaking a moment problem poses the question: Under given constraints (e.g. measures supported within a fixed subset of $\mathbb{R}^n$), to what extent can one determine a solution μ (if one exists) from a moment sequence?

The classical study of moment problems is divided into three cases depending on the support of μ . In each case there is a standard choice of support, from which general results are often derived by a change of variables.

Markov (or **Hausdorff**) moment problems within a bounded support.

$$\text{supp}(\mu) \subseteq [0, 1]$$

Stieltjes moment problems within a one-sided infinite support.

$$\text{supp}(\mu) \subseteq [0, \infty)$$

Hamburger moment problems within a two-sided infinite support.

$$\text{supp}(\mu) \subseteq \mathbb{R}$$

In some special cases we will denote the moments c_k in a particular form:

- (i) When μ is absolutely continuous with respect to the Lebesgue measure dx , moments can be defined by

$$c_k = \int f(x) x^k dx$$

where $f(x)$ is the density of μ with respect to dx .

- (ii) When μ is the Lebesgue measure on a set $A \subset \mathbb{R}$ of finite measure, moments can be defined by

$$c_k = \int_A x^k dx.$$

We often use these representations interchangeably. For example, we may say a function f is determinate, or a set A is indeterminate, if the corresponding measure μ has that property.

There are two natural questions one can ask about a moment problem:

Solvability: Does a solution μ exist possessing the given moments?

Determinacy: Is a solution unique? If not, what can be said about the set of solutions?

For our purposes we will assume existence. In terms of the shape reconstruction method of Chapter 3 it is taken as a given that a solution exists, but that we have access only to the moments. Furthermore in practical application we encounter a followup question to determinacy: How can we reconstruct the solution?

In the classical cases (Markov, Stieltjes, Hamburger) these questions have been more or less resolved. Precise conditions for solvable and determinate moment problems have been found, and the nature of solution sets to indeterminate moment problems are well understood. For instance, all solvable Markov moment problems are unique. This result follows from the Weierstrass approximation theorem:

1.2.1 Proposition. All Markov moment problems are determinate. If μ, ν are Borel measures on the unit interval $[0, 1]$ with equal moments,

$$\int_0^1 x^k d\mu = \int_0^1 x^k d\nu, \quad k \in \mathbb{N}_0,$$

then $\mu = \nu$.

1.2.2 Example. An example of an indeterminate Stieltjes moment problem?

However, in the case of multivariate moment problems remain largely open. Let μ be a Borel measure now on $\mathbb{R}^n$. For $\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n$. Define the α th multivariate moment of f as

$$c_\alpha = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} x^\alpha d\mu(x).$$

1.2.3 Example. Let $A = [0, 1]^n \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$ be the unit cube and μ the Lebesgue measure on A . Then μ has multivariate moments

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} x^\alpha d\mu(x) &= \int_{[0,1]^n} x_1^{\alpha_1} x_2^{\alpha_2} \cdots x_n^{\alpha_n} dx \\ &= \int_0^1 x_1^{\alpha_1} dx_1 \int_0^1 x_2^{\alpha_2} dx_2 \cdots \int_0^1 x_n^{\alpha_n} dx_n \\ &= \frac{1}{(\alpha_1 + 1)(\alpha_2 + 1) \cdots (\alpha_n + 1)} \end{aligned}$$

Similarly the Lebesgue measure μ on any rectangular region $A = \prod_{i=1}^n [a_i, b_i]$ has moments

$$\int_A x^\alpha d\mu(x) = \prod_{i=1}^n \int_{a_i}^{b_i} x_i^{\alpha_i} dx_i = \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{b_i^{\alpha_i+1} - a_i^{\alpha_i+1}}{\alpha_i + 1}$$

The moment sequence $(c_\alpha)_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n}$ is now multi-indexed, but the notions of solvability and determinacy are analogous: It is solvable provided there exists a Borel

measure with these moments, and it is determinate provided such a measure is unique. Here, we divide multivariate moment problems into two cases:

Bounded multivariate moment problems within a bounded support.

$$\text{supp}(\mu) \subseteq [0, 1]^n$$

Unbounded multivariate moment problems within an unbounded support.

$$\text{supp}(\mu) \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$$

While conditions for the solvability or determinacy of multivariate moment problems have been found in certain cases [CITATION NEEDED], they are nowhere near as comprehensive as those of classical moment problems. One straightforward, albeit limited, approach is to reduce an n -variate moment problem to a set of n univariate moment problems [18]. For example, we employ this strategy in our proofs of propositions [determinacy for bounded domain and gaussian measures].

As in the classical case of Markov moment problems, determinacy is a consequence of Stone-Weierstrass (n -variate polynomials):

1.2.4 Proposition. If μ is a Borel measure on the unit cube $A = [0, 1]^n$, with moments

$$c_\alpha = \int_A x^\alpha d\mu, \quad \alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n$$

then the moment problem $(c_\alpha)_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n}$ is determinate.

We present a simple alternate proof in chapter 2 via the Radon transform.

1.3 Gaussian measures and the Hermite polynomials

sec:gaussian

We review the definitions of univariate and multivariate Gaussian measures and Hermite polynomials, and discuss some basic properties. An extensive exposition of Gaussian measures can be found in [7]. The univariate Hermite polynomials are well known, but there are multiple multivariate generalizations. We use a simple product definition.

First we review some basic properties of the univariate Gaussian measure.

1.3.1 Definition. Let $\gamma(p) : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be the standard Gaussian density on $\mathbb{R}$,

$$\gamma(p) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} e^{-\frac{p^2}{2}}$$

and $\gamma_n(x) : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ the standard Gaussian density on $\mathbb{R}^n$,

$$\gamma_n(x) = (2\pi)^{-\frac{n}{2}} e^{-\frac{\|x\|^2}{2}}.$$

Note that $\gamma = \gamma_1$.

The normalization constant $(2\pi)^{-\frac{n}{2}}$ ensures that $\gamma_n(x)$ defines a probability distribution,

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \gamma(p) \, dp = 1.$$

The Gaussian density is analytic and satisfies

$$\gamma'(p) = -p\gamma(p)$$

in the univariate case and more generally,

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x_i} \gamma_n(x) = -x_i \gamma_n(x), \quad i = 1, \dots, n.$$

Notably, the exponential decay of $\gamma_n(x)$ at infinity means that the Gaussian density dominates polynomials in the sense that $P(x)\gamma_n(x) \rightarrow 0$ as $\|x\| \rightarrow \infty$, even

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^n} P(x) \gamma_n(x) \, dx < \infty$$

for all polynomials $P : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$.

1.3.2 Definition. The *Gaussian moments* of a function $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ are,

$$c_\alpha^\gamma = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) x^\alpha \gamma(x) \, dx$$

for $\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n$, provided they exist.

1.3.3 Example. Let $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be the constant function $f(p) = 1$. The Gaussian moments of f , i.e. the moments of $\gamma(p)$, are

$$c_k^\gamma = \begin{cases} (k-1)!!, & k \text{ even} \\ 0, & k \text{ odd} \end{cases}$$

We have already seen $c_0 = 1$. Furthermore it is not hard to see that for odd k ,

$$c_k^\gamma = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} p^k \gamma(p) \, dp = 0$$

since $p^k \gamma(p)$ is an odd function.

Now for $\ell = 1, 2, \dots$, we derive a recurrence formula for $c_{2\ell}$ by integrating by

parts

$$\begin{aligned}
c_{2\ell}^\gamma &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} p^{2\ell} \gamma(p) \, dp \\
&= - \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} p^{2\ell-1} (-p\gamma(p)) \, dp \\
&= - [p^{2\ell-1} \gamma(p)]_{-\infty}^{\infty} + (2\ell-1) \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} p^{2\ell-2} \gamma(p) \, dp \\
&= (2\ell-1) c_{2\ell-2}^\gamma.
\end{aligned}$$

Thus by induction,

$$c_{2\ell}^\gamma = (2\ell-1)(2\ell-3) \cdots c_0 = (2\ell-1)!!.$$

As an alternate derivation, for readers familiar with the gamma function $\Gamma(z) = \int_0^\infty t^{z-1} e^{-t} dt$ we present the following. Since $p^{2\ell} \gamma(p)$ is even,

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} p^{2\ell} e^{-\frac{p^2}{2}} dp = 2 \int_0^\infty p^{2\ell} e^{-\frac{p^2}{2}} dp$$

Now substituting $t = \frac{p^2}{2}$, whereby $dt = p \, dp$,

$$\begin{aligned}
2 \int_0^\infty p^{2\ell} e^{-\frac{p^2}{2}} dp &= 2^{\ell+\frac{1}{2}} \int_0^\infty t^{\ell-\frac{1}{2}} e^{-t} dt \\
&= 2^{\ell+\frac{1}{2}} \Gamma\left(\ell + \frac{1}{2}\right)
\end{aligned}$$

so that

$$c_{2\ell}^\gamma = \frac{2^\ell}{\sqrt{\pi}} \Gamma\left(\ell + \frac{1}{2}\right) = (2\ell-1)!!$$

A relationship between the univariate and multivariate Gaussian densities can be seen as follows: Let $x, y \in \mathbb{R}^n$, $n \geq 2$. Suppose $y = p\omega$ where $\omega \in S^{n-1}$ and $p \in \mathbb{R}$, so that $p\omega$ is the orthogonal projection of x onto the span of y . Then the Pythagorean relation,

$$\|x\|^2 = \|x - p\omega\|^2 + \|p\omega\|^2 = \|x - p\omega\|^2 + p^2$$

implies that

$$\begin{aligned}
\gamma_n(x) &= (2\pi)^{-\frac{n}{2}} e^{-\frac{\|x\|^2}{2}} \\
&= (2\pi)^{-\frac{n-1}{2}} e^{-\frac{\|x-p\omega\|^2}{2}} (2\pi)^{-\frac{1}{2}} e^{-\frac{p^2}{2}} \\
&= \gamma_{n-1}(x - p\omega) \gamma(p)
\end{aligned}$$

The equation

$$\gamma_n(x) = \gamma_{n-1}(x - p\omega)\gamma(p) \quad (1.3.1) \quad \boxed{\text{eq:gaussPythag}}$$

is in some respect the defining property of the Gaussian measure described below. Indeed if $x = (x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)$, by repeated application of (1.3.1) one can write the decomposition

$$\gamma_n(x) = \prod_{k=1}^n \gamma(x_k).$$

Thus the $\gamma_n(x)$ is the product of n copies of γ . The standard Gaussian measure γ^n is thus a measure whose cardinal projections are standard Gaussian measures.

1.3.4 Example. Let $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be the constant function $f(x) = 1$. The Gaussian moments of f are the multivariate moments of $\gamma_n(x)$, and can be written

$$\begin{aligned} c_\alpha^\gamma &= \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} x^\alpha \gamma_n(x) \, dx \\ &= \prod_{i=1}^n \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x_i^{\alpha_i} \gamma(x_i) \, dx \\ &= \prod_{i=1}^n c_{\alpha_i}^\gamma \end{aligned}$$

where $\{c_k^\gamma\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$ are the univariate moments of $\gamma(p)$. Thus $c_\alpha^\gamma = 0$ if any α_i is odd. Otherwise, if every α_i is even then

$$c_\alpha^\gamma = \prod_{i=1}^n (\alpha_i - 1)!!$$

1.3.5 Definition. The **Hermite polynomials** can be defined by the Rodrigues formula

$$H_k(p) = (-1)^k \frac{\gamma^{(k)}(p)}{\gamma(p)}$$

We can derive a recurrence relation for H_k with some basic differential calculus. First multiplying both sides by $(-1)^k \gamma(p)$, we get

$$\gamma^{(k)}(p) = (-1)^k \gamma(p) H_k(p)$$

Now we differentiate both sides

$$\gamma^{(k+1)}(p) = (-1)^k (-p\gamma(p)H_k(p) + \gamma(p)H'_k(p)) = (-1)^{k+1} \gamma(p)(pH_k(p) - H'_k(p))$$

so that, dividing both sides by $(-1)^{k+1} \gamma(p)$, we have

$$H_{k+1}(p) = pH_k(p) - H'_k(p)$$

Since $H_0(p)$ is trivially the constant 1 we compute the first handful of polynomials:

$$\begin{aligned} H_0(p) &= 1 \\ H_1(p) &= p \\ H_2(p) &= p^2 - 1 \\ H_3(p) &= p^3 - 3p \\ H_4(p) &= p^4 - 6p^2 + 3 \\ H_5(p) &= p^5 - 10p^3 + 15p \end{aligned}$$

Note that each H_k is a monic polynomial of degree k , and H_k is an even (odd resp.) function if k is even (odd resp.). The Hermite polynomials are mutually orthogonal in the sense that for nonnegative integers $\ell < k$,

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} H_\ell(p) H_k(p) \gamma(p) dp = 0 \quad (1.3.2) \quad \boxed{\text{eq:HOrth}}$$

To see this, substitute the Rodrigues formula for H_k ,

$$(-1)^k \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} H_\ell(p) \gamma^{(k)}(p) dp$$

and integrate by parts

$$\begin{aligned} (-1)^k \left([H_k(p) \gamma^{(k-1)}(p)]_{-\infty}^{\infty} - \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} H'_\ell(p) \gamma^{(k-1)}(p) dp \right) \\ = (-1)^{k-1} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} H'_\ell(p) \gamma^{(k-1)}(p) dp \end{aligned}$$

where the boundary term $[H_k(p) \gamma^{(k-1)}(p)]_{-\infty}^{\infty}$ vanishes because of $\gamma(p)$'s rapid decay at $\pm\infty$. Repeat this process until H_ℓ is annihilated.

The Hermite polynomials form a complete orthogonal basis for $L^2(\gamma)$, the space of function $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ for which $\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f(p)^2 \gamma(p) dp < \infty$. This is a Hilbert space with inner product $\langle f, g \rangle = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f(p) g(p) \gamma(p) dp$.

1.3.6 Proposition. The linear span of the Hermite polynomials $H_0(p), H_1(p), \dots$ is dense in $L^2(\mathbb{R}, \gamma)$.

1.3.7 Corollary. For any $f \in L^2(\mathbb{R})$ the moment problem given by

$$c_n = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f(p) \gamma(p) dp$$

is determinate.

In the chapter 4 we will make use of a different definition for the Hermite polynomials, as Taylor series coefficients for an exponential generating function.

1.3.8 Lemma. The Hermite polynomials have the **generating function**,

$$\phi(p) = e^{pt - \frac{t^2}{2}} = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{H_k(p)}{k!} t^k.$$

which converges absolutely for all $p, t \in \mathbb{R}$.

Proof. Note that

$$e^{pt - \frac{t^2}{2}} = \frac{e^{-\frac{(p-t)^2}{2}}}{e^{-\frac{p^2}{2}}} = \frac{\gamma(p-t)}{\gamma(p)}$$

so that the Taylor coefficients are precisely

$$\left[\frac{d^k}{dt^k} \frac{\gamma(p-t)}{\gamma(p)} \right]_{t=0} = (-1)^k \frac{\gamma^{(k)}(p)}{\gamma(p)} = H_k(p).$$

□

We can now define a straight forward multivariate analogue of the Hermite polynomials

1.3.9 Definition. For $\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n$ we define the **multivariate Hermite polynomial** H_α by

$$H_\alpha(x) = H_{\alpha_1}(x_1) \cdots H_{\alpha_n}(x_n), \quad x = (x_1, \dots, x_n) \in \mathbb{R}^n$$

The multivariate Hermite polynomials have many useful properties corresponding to those of the classical polynomials. In particular we have the Rodrigues formula

$$H_\alpha(x) = (-1)^{|\alpha|} \frac{\partial_\alpha \gamma_n(x)}{\gamma_n(x)}$$

where $\partial_\alpha = \frac{\partial^{\alpha_1 + \dots + \alpha_n}}{\partial x_1^{\alpha_1} \dots \partial x_n^{\alpha_n}}$ is a partial differential operator. Just like the classical case, this formula can be used to define H_α as multivariate Taylor coefficients for the generating function:

$$\phi(x) = e^{\langle x, y \rangle - \frac{\|y\|^2}{2}} = \frac{\gamma_n(x-y)}{\gamma_n(x)} = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n} \frac{H_\alpha(x)}{\alpha!} y^\alpha$$

which we note is absolutely convergent for all $x, y \in \mathbb{R}^n$. Here we use the same symbol ϕ for the univariate and multivariate generating functions at the risk of confusion. It should be clear from context.

sec:RTGRT

1.4 The Radon and Gaussian Radon transforms

Let f be a function on the n -dimensional Euclidean space $\mathbb{R}^n$. We imagine taking “slices” of f by restricting it to a $(n - 1)$ -dimensional hyperplane Λ . These hyperplanes form the domain of the Radon Transform. More precisely, the Radon Transform associates each slice with a corresponding integral

$$R_f(\Lambda) = \int_{\Lambda} f(x) \, dx,$$

which can be thought of as a $(n - 1)$ -dimensional measurement of f . To be more precise we parametrize the collection of hyperplanes Λ by normal vector, $\omega \in S^{n-1}$, and (signed) distance from the origin $-\infty < p < \infty$. Indeed any hyperplane can be described in the form $\Lambda = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^n : \langle x, \omega \rangle = p\}$. As mentioned, there is a slight inconsistency in these definitions where a hyperplane Λ can be indexed by both $\langle \omega, x \rangle = p$ and $\langle -\omega, x \rangle = -p$. This difference is inconsequential for our purposes so we choose the latter definition for clarity.

The Radon transform ^[Helg65]_[13] (RT) is a thing that I will discuss the history of, with references, in this paragraph. The transform gets its name from Johann Radon, whose first defined the transform in the form below in 1917, although a similar transform was introduced by Paul Funk in 1911. It is interesting to note that the primary application of the RT in medical imaging (CT scans) was not invented for another half century. I can only hope that in 2076 my dissertation will serve as an absorbent coffee coaster for a sleep deprived student.

1.4.1 Definition. Let f be a nonnegative measurable function on $\mathbb{R}^n$. The **Radon transform** $R_f : S^{n-1} \times \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ of f is a function which, given a unit vector $\omega \in \mathbb{R}^n$ and $p \in \mathbb{R}$, is defined as

$$R_f(\omega, p) = \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = p} f(x) \, dx,$$

provided the integral converges.

1.4.2 Example. For computation it is convenient to write the Radon Transform with an explicit isometric parameterization $x(t)$ of the hyperplane $\langle x, \omega \rangle = p$. In particular we note that there exists a map $x : \mathbb{R}^{n-1} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n$ such that $x(0) = p\omega$ and

$$R_f(\omega, p) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^{n-1}} f(x(t)) dt.$$

For reference let's specify an hyperplane parameterization for the $n = 2$ case. In $\mathbb{R}^2$ often we identify ω with the angle $0 \leq \theta < 2\pi$ such that $\omega = (\cos \theta, \sin \theta)$. We define $x(t)$ by

$$x(t) = (t \sin \theta + p \cos \theta, -t \cos \theta + p \sin \theta), \quad -\infty < t < \infty.$$

It is not difficult to show that $x(0) = p\omega$, $\langle x(t), \omega \rangle = p$, and most importantly

$$R_f(\omega, p) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f(t \sin \theta + p \cos \theta, -t \cos \theta + p \sin \theta) dt$$

1.4.3 Example. Let $B(r) = \{x : |x| \leq r\} \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$ be the ball of radius r .

$$R_{B(r)}(\omega, p) = \begin{cases} V_{n-1} \left(\sqrt{r^2 - p^2} \right), & |p| \leq r \\ 0 & |p| > r \end{cases}$$

where $V_n(r)$ is the volume of a hypersphere of radius r ,

$$V_n(r) = \frac{\pi^{n/2}}{\Gamma(\frac{n}{2} + 1)} r^n.$$

Note that as a bounded domain, we can guarantee $B(r)$ is integrable on all hyperplanes. In fact, the RT of any subset $A \subseteq B(r)$ is bounded by

$$R_A \leq V_{n-1}(r).$$

Also note that $B(r)$ is rotation invariant, hence $R_{B(r)}(\omega, p)$ is independent of ω .

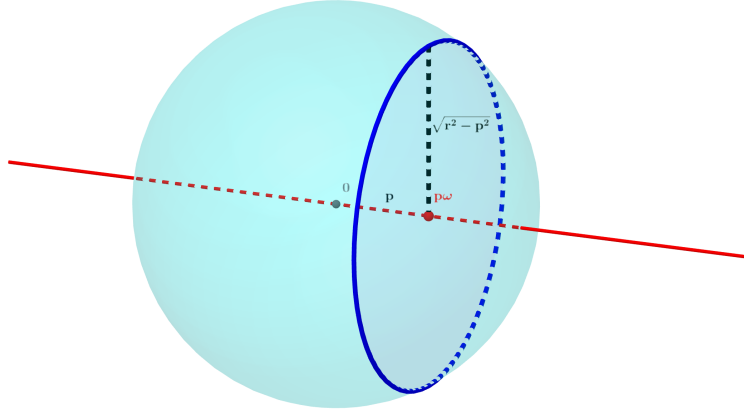


Figure 1.4.1: The RT of a ball

fig:RTBall

We can use this formula to determine the RT of an annulus. Let $A(r_1, r_2) = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^n : r_1 \leq \|x\| \leq r_2\}$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} R_{A(r_1, r_2)}(\omega, p) &= R_{B(r_2)}(\omega, p) - R_{B(r_1)}(\omega, p) \\ &= \begin{cases} V_{n-1}(\sqrt{r_2^2 - p^2}) - V_{n-1}(\sqrt{r_1^2 - p^2}), & |p| < r_1 \\ V_{n-1}(\sqrt{r_2^2 - p^2}), & r_1 \leq |p| \leq r_2 \\ 0, & |p| \geq r_2 \end{cases} \end{aligned}$$

Now consider an example of an unbounded region.

ex:RTStrip

1.4.4 Example. Let $S = \{(x, y) : |y| \leq \frac{1}{2}\} \subseteq \mathbb{R}^2$ be a strip centered on the x -axis with width 1. Clearly if $\theta = \pi/2$ or $3\pi/2$ then

$$R_S(\theta, p) = \begin{cases} \infty, & |p| \leq \frac{1}{2} \\ 0, & |p| > \frac{1}{2} \end{cases}.$$

Otherwise,

$$R_S(\theta, p) = \sec \theta$$

Note because S is unbounded, that R_S is not only unbounded, but even divergent in some cases.

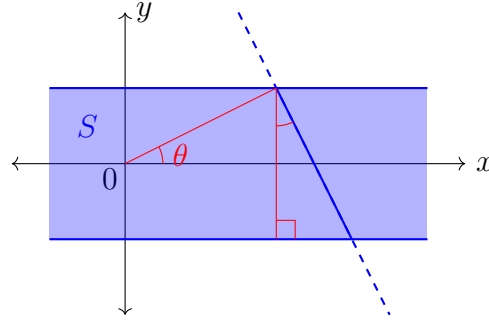


Figure 1.4.2: RT of a strip

fig:strip

Our main addition to previous work will be the use of a modified RT, the Gaussian Radon transform (GRT). This transform is very similar to the RT, but the inclusion of a Gaussian density $\gamma_{n-1}(x)$ in the integral allows for convergence on a larger class of functions f . This includes for example unbounded regions. In a broader context the Gaussian Radon transform also has the advantages of generalizing to infinite dimensional Hilbert spaces [15] (on which the Lebesgue measure is not defined), as well as having a natural probabilistic interpretation.

1.4.5 Definition. The *Gaussian Radon transform* $GR_f : S^{n-1} \times \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ of f is defined similarly to the RT. Given $\omega \in S^{n-1}$ and $-\infty < p < \infty$, the GRT is

$$GR_f(\omega, p) = \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = p} f(x) \gamma_{n-1}(x - p\omega) dx.$$

provided the integral converges. Note the Gaussian density

$$\gamma_{n-1}(x - p\omega) = (2\pi)^{-(n-1)/2} e^{-\|x - p\omega\|^2/2}$$

is centered on the point of the hyperplane closest to the origin.

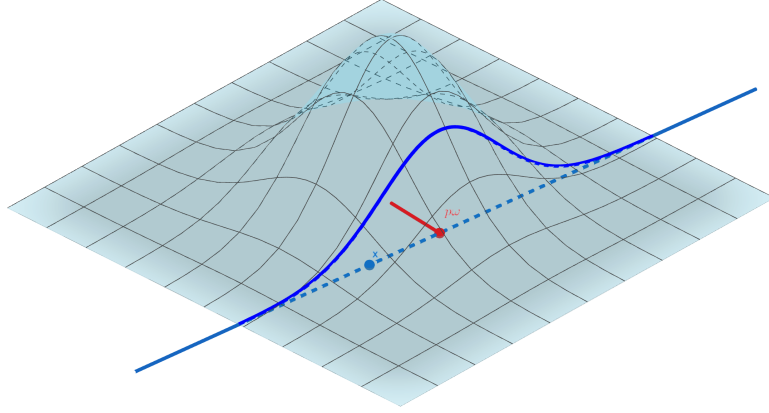


Figure 1.4.3: The GRT

fig:GRT

1.4.6 Remark. It may be helpful to understand the GRT as a simple modification of the RT with respect to a Gaussian measure on $\mathbb{R}^n$. From the relation

$$\int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = p} f(x) \gamma_n(x) dx = \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = p} f(x) \gamma_{n-1}(x) dx \gamma(p),$$

we can express the GRT of f in terms of the RT of the function $g(x) = f(x) \gamma_n(x)$:

$$R_g(\omega, p) = GR_f(\omega, p) \gamma(p), \quad g(x) := f(x) \gamma_n(x). \quad (1.4.1)$$

eq:GRTPythag

The relation above provides decent intuition for the GRT, and is also a useful tool proving some basic properties of the transform. Expand on intuition (maybe with example.)

1.4.7 Example. If $x(t) : \mathbb{R}^{n-1} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n$ is a parametrization of $\langle x, \omega \rangle = p$ as described above, then

$$GR_f(\omega, p) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^{n-1}} f(x(t)) \gamma_{n-1}(t) dt$$

In particular for $f : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$

$$GR_f(\omega, p) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f(t \sin \theta + p \cos \theta, -t \cos \theta + p \sin \theta) \gamma(t) dt$$

where $\omega = (\cos \theta, \sin \theta)$.

1.4.8 Example. The Gaussian Radon transform is bounded for any measurable

region $A \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$. Indeed

$$GR_A(\omega, p) \leq \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = p} \gamma_{n-1}(x) \, dx = 1$$

1.4.9 Example. Consider the strip $S \subseteq \mathbb{R}^2$ from example [1.4.4](#)^{ex:RTStrip}. While the RT of S was divergent for $\theta = \pi/2$ or $3\pi/2$, the GRT converges. In particular,

$$GR_S(\theta, p) = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} e^{-\frac{p^2}{2}}, & |p| \leq \frac{1}{2} \\ 0, & |p| > \frac{1}{2} \end{cases}$$

This is the density of a “truncated” normal distribution on $[-\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}]$. For other angles $GR_S(\theta, p)$ is likewise the density of a truncated normal distribution, this time with arbitrary endpoints $[a, b]$, given by

$$a = ?, \quad b = a + \sec \theta$$

Now imagine sweeping a hyperplanar “slice” across $\mathbb{R}^n$. As a function of p , $R(\omega, p)$ can be seen as a projection of f onto the linear subspace spanned by ω . It is not surprising that integrating this projection over $-\infty < p < \infty$ we get the same result as the n -fold integral of f over $\mathbb{R}^n$.

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} R(\omega, p) \, dp = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) \, dx$$

The following theorem further generalizes this observation:

1.4.10 Proposition (Slice Theorem). If $f \in L^1(\mathbb{R}^n)$ and $F \in L^\infty(\mathbb{R})$, then

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} R_f(\omega, p) F(p) \, dp = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) F(\langle x, \omega \rangle) \, dx, \quad (1.4.2) \quad \boxed{\text{eq:ST}}$$

Proof. This is a corollary of the Fubini-Tonelli theorem, which guarantees the slice formula as the integrals on either side converge absolutely. To see this note that there is a rigid transformation (Hilbert space isomorphism) taking this to an iterated integral over $\mathbb{R}^{n-1}$ and $\mathbb{R}$. Further, $F(\langle x, \omega \rangle) \in L^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n)$, so the proposition follows by Hölder’s inequality

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^n} |f(x) F(\langle x, \omega \rangle)| \, dx \leq \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} |f(x)| \, dx \|F(\langle x, \omega \rangle)\|_\infty < \infty$$

□

1.4.11 Remark. The sufficient conditions for the slice theorem above can loosened significantly. We can take for example the straightforward Fubini condition

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^n} |f(x) F(\langle x, \omega \rangle)| < \infty$$

which is necessary, but not convenient. We may also use the condition f has bounded support and $F \in L^1_{loc}(\mathbb{R})$.

The conditions on f and F can be reduced somewhat. In general the convergence of either the left or right side above is sufficient. One

If $F(p) = e^{-ip}$ and $f(x)$ is such that $\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} R_f(\omega, p) dp < \infty$ then (eq:ST) becomes the well known Fourier slice theorem

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} R_f(\omega, p) e^{-ip} dp = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) e^{-i\langle x, \omega \rangle} dx,$$

which is often articulated as saying that the 1-dimensional Fourier transform of the Radon transform is the n -dimensional Fourier transform of f .

An early and natural question in the study of the RT is that of inversion. Radon himself derived the “Radon inversion formula” [19] [20], which is often proved via the above Fourier slice theorem. The groundbreaking inversion formula is the basis for what, in application, called “filtered back-propagation”.

If one is interested in inverting the RT then a prerequisite concern is of course: Is the transform injective? The answer clearly depends on what space we draw the function f from. Radon [19] [20] provides a set of sufficient regularity conditions such that the RT is invertible. On the other hand counterexamples have been constructed by, for example, Lawrence Zalcman [26], of continuous and nontrivial functions for which the RT is identically zero.

By way of the relation (eq:GRTPythag) we can prove an analogous slice theorem for the GRT. Mihai and Sengupta give a more general result for the GRT on real, separable, infinite Hilbert spaces [17].

1.4.12 Proposition (Gaussian Slice Theorem). Let $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ and $F : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be measurable functions. If $f \in L^1(\mathbb{R}^n, \gamma_n)$ and $F \in L^\infty(\mathbb{R})$ then

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} GR_f(\omega, p) F(p) \gamma(p) dp = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) F(\langle x, \omega \rangle) \gamma_n(x) dx. \quad (1.4.3) \quad \boxed{\text{eq:GST}}$$

1.4.13 Remark. Again the more general Fubini condition

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^n} |f(x) F(\langle x, \omega \rangle) \gamma_n(x)| dx < \infty$$

may be used. Further, whatever conditions on f and F are sufficient for convergence in (eq:ST) are then sufficient conditions to be checked of $f(x) \gamma_n(x)$ and $F(p) \gamma(p)$. I’ll need to check these conditions more carefully.

Proof. From (eq:GRTPythag)

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} GR_f(\omega, p) F(p) \gamma(p) dp = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} R_g(\omega, p) F(p) dp$$

where $g(x) = f(x)e^{-\|x\|^2/2}$. Then applying the slice theorem:

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} R_g(\omega, p) F(p) dp = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) F(\langle x, \omega \rangle) \gamma_n(x) dx,$$

completing the proof. $\square$

sec:RTmeasure

1.5 The Radon transform of measures

Taking from the context of classical moment problems we should define the notion of the Radon transform of a measure μ . Let μ be a Borel measure on $\mathbb{R}^n$ with finite moments c_α , $\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n$. The projection $\pi_\omega : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ given by

$$\pi_\omega(x) = \langle x, \omega \rangle$$

is a Borel function, thus we may define the push-forward measure $\mu_\omega = \mu \circ \pi_\omega^{-1}$ which for Borel sets $A \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ is given by,

$$\mu_\omega(A) = \mu(\pi_\omega^{-1}(A)) = \mu(\{x : \langle x, \omega \rangle \in A\}).$$

We may call μ_ω the **marginal projection measure** of μ with direction vector ω .

Notice that if μ is absolutely continuous with density representation $\mu = f(x)dx$ then the slice theorem with $F(p)$ the characteristic function of A gives,

$$\mu(\pi_\omega^{-1}(A)) = \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle \in A} f(x) dx = \int_A R_f(\omega, p) dp$$

so that in fact μ_ω is absolutely continuous with respect to the Lebesgue measure dp and its density is precisely the Radon transform $R_f(\omega, p)$. In this sense the marginal projection μ_ω is a natural generalization of the RT, so we define

1.5.1 Definition. The Radon transform of a Borel measure μ on $\mathbb{R}$ is defined as the push-forward measure $\mu_\omega = \mu \circ \pi_\omega^{-1}$ on $\mathbb{R}$, where $\pi_\omega : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is the projection

$$\pi_\omega(x) = \langle x, \omega \rangle.$$

We may denote this measure by $R_\mu^\omega = \mu_\omega$.

1.5.2 Remark. It seems that the slice theorem is analogous to — and perhaps generalized by — the change of variables formula for the push-forward measure R_μ^ω :

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} F(p) dR_\mu^\omega(p) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} F(\pi_\omega(x)) d\mu$$

where $F : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is integrable with respect to dR_μ^ω if and only if $F \circ \pi_\omega : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is integrable with respect to μ .

1.6 The Stieltjes transform

Let μ be a Borel measure with finite moments $c_k = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} p^k d\mu$.

1.6.1 Definition. The function $g : \mathbb{C} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ defined by

$$g(z) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{d\mu}{1 + zp}$$

is called the Markov (Hamburger resp.) transform of μ when μ has bounded (unbounded resp.) support.

It is worth noting at the outset that $g(z)$ is defined at least for non-real z . To see this we note that if $\text{Im } z \neq 0$,

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{|1 + zp|} &= \frac{|1/z|}{|\frac{1}{z} + p|} \\ &\leq \frac{|1/z|}{|\text{Im } \frac{1}{z}|} \\ &= \frac{|\bar{z}|/|z|^2}{|\text{Im } \bar{z}|/|z|^2} \\ &= \frac{|z|}{|\text{Im } z|} \end{aligned}$$

which gives the bound

$$|g(z)| \leq \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{|z|}{|\text{Im } z|} d\mu(p) = \frac{|z|}{|\text{Im } z|} c_0 \quad (1.6.1)$$

Since the integrand has a singularity only when $p = -1/z$ a Markov transform must converge in some neighborhood of zero. This cannot be said in general for a Hamburger transform.

1.6.2 Remark. The bound above has a useful geometric interpretation. For starters we note that,

$$\frac{|\text{Im } z|}{|z|} = |\sin(\arg z)|,$$

which can be seen by considering the right triangle formed by the points 0, z , and $\text{Re } z$. Thus this bound essentially depends on the angle of separation between z and the real line.

1.6.3 Proposition. The function $g(z)$ is analytic on the upper and lower half planes $\text{Im } z \neq 0$.

Proof. Let z, w be complex numbers with non-zero imaginary part. We have

$$\begin{aligned} g(w) - g(z) &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{1}{1+wp} - \frac{1}{1+zp} d\mu(p) \\ &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{(1+zp) - (1+wp)}{(1+wp)(1+zp)} d\mu(p) \\ &= (w-z) \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{-p}{(1+wp)(1+zp)} d\mu(p). \end{aligned}$$

Thus it seems

$$\lim_{w \rightarrow z} \frac{g(w) - g(z)}{w - z} = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{-p}{(1+zp)^2} d\mu(p).$$

To be precise we may justify the interchange of limit and integral here by dominated convergence. Recall that it suffices to find an integrable function $h : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ such that, for any w in a neighborhood of z ,

$$\left| \frac{-p}{(1+wp)(1+zp)} \right| \leq h(p) \quad \text{for all } p \in \mathbb{R}.$$

It should be noted that our particular dominating function $h(p)$ is somewhat arbitrary, and not a sharp bound. By the previously discussed bound we have,

$$\left| \frac{-p}{(1+wp)(1+zp)} \right| \leq |p| \frac{|wz|}{|\operatorname{Im} w \operatorname{Im} z|}.$$

Furthermore $|w|/|\operatorname{Im} w|$ is clearly continuous on the half planes, so in some neighborhood of

$$|p| \frac{|wz|}{|\operatorname{Im} w \operatorname{Im} z|} \leq |p| \left(\frac{|z|^2}{|\operatorname{Im} z|^2} + \epsilon \right)$$

for an arbitrary $\epsilon > 0$. Finally, we note that the right hand dominating function above is integrable since μ has finite moments:

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |p| d\mu \leq \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{1}{2} (p^2 + 1) d\mu = \frac{c_2 + c_0}{2} < \infty$$

□

1.6.4 Remark. Since μ is a real measure, $g(z)$ commutes with conjugation,

$$g(\bar{z}) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{d\mu}{1+\bar{z}p} = \overline{\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{d\mu}{1+zp}} = \overline{g(z)}.$$

For this reason, although $g(z)$ is defined for all non-real z , we will only concern ourselves with its values on the upper half plane $\operatorname{Im} z > 0$ going forward. In chapter 3 we should restrict our sample points to the upper half plane, since samples in the lower half may be redundant.

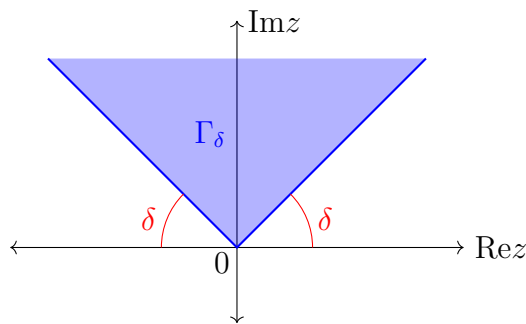


Figure 1.6.1: A wedge domain

fig:wedge

When z is a real number $g(z)$ may not converge. In particular $g(z)$ does not converge when $z = -1/p$ for some p in the support of μ . Thus if μ has bounded support g converges in a neighborhood of 0. On the other hand if μ has unbounded support $g(0)$ is not defined. However — as we will see — even in the Hamburger transform case, a formal series expansion at $z = 0$ holds valuable information. The results of this section are described in detail in section 5.6 of [3].

By a geometric series expansion,

$$\frac{1}{1+zp} = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (-z)^k p^k$$

when $|zp| < 1$. This suggests the connection between $g(z)$ and the moment sequence $(c_k)_{k \in \mathbb{N}_0}$. Indeed, at least formally,

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{d\mu}{1+zp} &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (-z)^k p^k d\mu \\ &= \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (-z)^k \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} p^k d\mu \\ &= \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} c_k (-z)^k. \end{aligned}$$

In the Markov case we have a positive radius of convergence. But even in the Hamburger case, there is a sense in which this asymptotic expansion holds “non-tangentially”.

Non-tangential convergence at $z = 0$ is, as the name implies, convergence along curves not tangent to the real line at 0. More precisely, one defines a “wedge domain”

$$\Gamma_{\delta} = \{\delta \leq \arg z \leq \pi - \delta\}$$

in which curves approach 0 with an angle at least δ from the real line.

1.6.5 Definition. (Non-tangential convergence and asymptotic expansion) We say $h(z) \rightarrow 0$ non-tangentially as $z \rightarrow 0$ if, for any $\delta > 0$, the limit

$$\lim_{z \rightarrow 0} h(z) = 0$$

holds for z in the Γ_δ . If a formal power series $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_k z^k$ and a function $g(z)$ are such that for all $n \in \mathbb{N}_0$,

$$g(z) = \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} c_k (-z)^k + z^n h_n(z)$$

where the trailing terms $h_n(z)$ converge to 0 non-tangentially as $z \rightarrow 0$, we say that $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_k z^k$ is an asymptotic expansion of $g(z)$. We use the notation

$$g(z) \simeq \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_k z^k$$

for asymptotic expansions.

While $g(z)$ does not generally converge at $z = 0$, in a non-tangential sense the aforementioned asymptotic expansion holds:

1.6.6 Proposition. (i) If μ has bounded support

$$g(z) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} c_k (-z)^k$$

in a neighborhood of $z = 0$.

(ii) For all $n \in \mathbb{N}_0$

$$g(z) = \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} c_k (-z)^k + z^n h_n(z) \tag{1.6.2} \quad \boxed{\text{asexp}}$$

where h_n is such that $\lim_{z \rightarrow 0} h_n(z) = 0$ non-tangentially.

Proof. We first note that

$$\sum_{k=0}^n c_k (-z)^k = \sum_{k=0}^n \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} (-zp)^k d\mu = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{1 - (-zp)^{n+1}}{1 + zp} d\mu$$

and so

$$h_n(z) = \frac{1}{z^n} \left\{ g(z) - \sum_{k=0}^n c_k (-z)^k \right\} = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{zp^{n+1}}{1 + zp} d\mu.$$

It remains to determine if and in what sense this trailing term $h_n(z)$ vanishes at the origin.

As expected in the case when μ has bounded support, $h_n(z)$ exists in a neighborhood of 0 and vanishes as $z \rightarrow 0$ in this neighborhood. Thus the asymptotic expansion ^{1.6.2} is the Taylor expansion: The Markov transform is analytic at the origin.

When μ has unbounded support and $h_n(z)$ may not be well defined on the real line, so we must weaken our result to non-tangential convergence. If $z \in \Gamma_\delta$ then we have the following inequalities for any $p \in \mathbb{R}$,

$$|p - z| \geq |p| \sin \delta \quad \text{and} \quad |p - z| \geq |p| \sin \delta.$$

We will show that

$$\lim_{z \rightarrow 0} h_{2n}(z) = 0, \quad z \in \Gamma_\delta$$

from which the corresponding limit for odd orders will immediately follow from the relation

$$h_{2n-1}(z) = zh_{2n}(z) + c_{2n}z^{2n}.$$

Here for the sake of convenience we define $w = -\frac{1}{z}$, following a more classical approach. Note that $|w| = \frac{1}{|z|}$ and if z is in the wedge Γ_δ then so is w . Now

$$\begin{aligned} |h_{2n}(z)| &\leq \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{|p|^{2n+1}}{|p - w|} d\mu \\ &\leq \frac{|z|}{\sin \delta} \int_{|p| \leq A} |p|^{2n+1} d\mu + \frac{1}{\sin \delta} \int_{|p| \geq A} p^{2n} d\mu \\ &\leq \frac{2|z|A^{2n+2}}{\sin \delta} + \frac{1}{\sin \delta} \int_{|p| \geq A} p^{2n} d\mu \end{aligned}$$

Thus

$$\lim_{z \rightarrow 0} |h_{2n}(z)| \leq \frac{1}{\sin \delta} \int_{|p| \geq A} p^{2n} d\mu, \quad z \in \Gamma_\delta.$$

Since A is arbitrary and the integral $\int p^{2n} d\mu = c_{2n}$ is convergent we are done. $\square$

Evidently the asymptotic series expansion $g(z) \simeq \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} c_k(-z)^k$ is generally formal, having zero radius of convergence except in the Markov case. However as we will see in the next section, rational functions constructed from this formal series exist which approximate $g(z)$ on the upper half plane $\{\text{Im} z > 0\}$.

Finally we prove two propositions regarding the Hamburger transform of a RT projection. Let $\omega \in S^{n-1}$ be fixed and consider

$$g(z) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{R(\omega, p)}{1 + zp} dp$$

for some function $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$.

1.6.7 Definition. The multivariate Markov (Hamburger resp.) transform of a Borel measure μ on $\mathbb{R}^n$ of bounded (unbounded resp.) support is defined by

$$g(y) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} \frac{d\mu(x)}{1 + \langle x, y \rangle} \simeq \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n} c_\alpha (-y)^\alpha$$

when μ has finite moments $c_\alpha = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} x^\alpha d\mu$.

By applying the slice theorem, with $F(p) = (1 + zp)^{-1}$ we see that the Hamburger transform of a projection can be represented by a similar multivariate integral of f over $\mathbb{R}^n$.

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{R_f(\omega, p)}{1 + zp} dp = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} \frac{f(x)}{1 + z\langle x, \omega \rangle} dx$$

Similarly the GRT slice theorem with $F(p) = (1 + zp)^{-1}$ is

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{GR_f(\omega, p)\gamma(p)}{1 + zp} dp = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} \frac{f(x)\gamma_n(x)}{1 + z\langle x, \omega \rangle} dx.$$

sec:pade

1.7 Padé approximants

In this section we recall the necessary definitions and results. Then we will prove some new results to be applied to the Gaussian Radon transform later.

1.7.1 Definition (Classical definition). The Padé approximant to a (possibly formal) power series

$$R^{[L/M]}(z) \simeq \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} c_k z^k$$

is a rational function with numerator (denominator resp.) degree at most L (M resp.), with series equal to $\sum_{k=0}^N c_k z^k + O(z^{N+1})$ up to as high an order N as possible.

Let

$$R^{[L/M]}(z) = \frac{P^{[L/M]}(z)}{Q^{[L/M]}(z)} = \frac{a_L z^L + \cdots + a_1 z + a_0}{b_M z^M + \cdots + b_1 z + b_0}.$$

Notice that in general there is a negligible constant common factor between the numerator and denominator, so that with the remaining $L+M+1$ free parameters, we expect an order of accuracy of up to $L+M+1$ constraints, $c_0, c_1, \dots, c_{L+M}$. Thus we define the $[L/M]$ Padé approximant by the condition,

$$\frac{P^{[L/M]}(z)}{Q^{[L/M]}(z)} = \sum_{k=0}^{L+M} c_k z^k + O(z^{L+M+1}). \quad (1.7.1) \quad \text{eq:BPade}$$

Multiplying by $Q^{[L/M]}(z)$ gives a necessary condition, with a subtle but important difference from (eq:BPade)

$$P^{[L/M]}(z) = Q^{[L/M]}(z) \left(\sum_{k=0}^{L+M} c_k z^k \right) + O(z^{L+M+1}). \quad (1.7.2) \quad \boxed{\text{eq:CPade}}$$

In the classical theory of Padé approximants (eq:CPade) was often taken as a definition. It is always possible to find polynomials of the required degree satisfying this second condition, however they do not necessarily attain the degree of accuracy required by the first. We follow Baker, defining $R^{[L/M]}(z)$ by (eq:BPade) , provided such a rational function exists.

1.7.2 Definition (Baker's definition). The Padé approximant $R^{[L/M]}$ to a (possibly formal) power series is the unique rational function with numerator (denominator resp.) degree at most L (M resp.) satisfying the condition (eq:BPade)

$$\frac{P^{[L/M]}(z)}{Q^{[L/M]}(z)} = \sum_{k=0}^{L+M} c_k z^k + O(z^{L+M+1}).$$

If no such rational function exists we say the Padé approximant does not exist.

Note that the two definitions are equivalent if $b_0 = Q^{L/M}(0) \neq 0$ [**PROOF NEEDED**]. Hence a sufficient condition for the existence of the Padé approximant by Baker's definition is that $b_0 = Q^{L/M}(0) \neq 0$.

Equating coefficients of z^k , $k = 0, 1, \dots, L+M$ in (eq:CPade) gives two linear systems

$$\begin{aligned} a_0 &= b_0 c_0 \\ a_1 &= b_1 c_0 + b_0 c_1 \\ &\vdots \\ a_L &= b_L c_0 + b_{L-1} c_1 + \dots + b_0 c_L \end{aligned}$$

and,

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &= b_M c_{L-M+1} + b_{M-1} c_{L-M+2} + \dots + b_0 c_{L+1} \\ 0 &= b_M c_{L-M+2} + b_{M-1} c_{L-M+3} + \dots + b_0 c_{L+2} \\ &\vdots \\ 0 &= b_M c_L + b_{M-1} c_{L+1} + \dots + b_0 c_{L+M} \end{aligned}$$

where for convenience we set $c_k = 0$ for $k < 0$. The first system shows the numerator $P^{[L/M]}$ is determined by the denominator $Q^{[L/M]}$ (explicitly computing the each coefficient $a_1, \dots, a_L$ from $b_1, \dots, b_L$). The second linear system is homogeneous, with M equations in $M+1$ unknowns. Thus we are guaranteed a nontrivial solution, and hence a Padé approximant by the classical definition. A clever modification of the latter system gives us a determinantal formula for

$Q^{[L/M]}$. Augmented with the desired definition,

$$Q^{[L/M]}(z) = b_M z^M + b_{M-1} z^{M-1} + \cdots + b_0$$

the system (now with dimension $M + 1 \times M + 1$) can be written in vector form,

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \\ Q^{[L/M]}(z) \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} c_{L-M+1} & c_{L-M+2} & \cdots & c_{L+1} \\ c_{L-M+2} & c_{L-M+3} & \cdots & c_{L+2} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ c_L & c_{L+1} & \cdots & c_{L+M} \\ z^M & z^{M-1} & \cdots & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} b_M \\ b_{M-1} \\ \vdots \\ b_1 \\ b_0 \end{pmatrix}$$

Solving for b_0 by Cramer's Rule we get,

$$b_0 \begin{vmatrix} c_{L-M+1} & c_{L-M+2} & \cdots & c_{L+1} \\ c_{L-M+2} & c_{L-M+3} & \cdots & c_{L+2} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ c_L & c_{L+1} & \cdots & c_{L+M} \\ z^M & z^{M-1} & \cdots & 1 \end{vmatrix} = \begin{vmatrix} c_{L-M+1} & c_{L-M+2} & \cdots & c_L \\ c_{L-M+2} & c_{L-M+3} & \cdots & c_{L+1} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ c_L & c_{L+1} & \cdots & c_{L+M-1} \end{vmatrix} Q^{[L/M]}(z).$$

The LHS is a polynomial by Laplace expansion, and is nonzero if the RHS minor has nonzero determinant. Thus if the determinant

$$\begin{vmatrix} c_{L-M+1} & \cdots & c_L \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ c_L & \cdots & c_{L+M-1} \end{vmatrix}$$

is nonzero, then up to the aforementioned constant factor,

$$Q^{[L/M]}(z) = \begin{vmatrix} c_{L-M+1} & \cdots & c_{L+1} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ c_L & \cdots & c_{L+M} \\ z^M & \cdots & 1 \end{vmatrix} \quad (1.7.3) \quad \boxed{\text{eq:Qdet}}$$

By convention we normalize $R^{[L/M]}(z)$ so that $b_0 = Q^{[L/M]}(0) = 1$. In terms of the determinantal formula above, we can write $Q^{[L/M]}(0)$ as

$$Q^{[L/M]}(0) = \begin{vmatrix} c_{L-M+1} & \cdots & c_L & c_{L+1} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots & \vdots \\ c_L & \cdots & c_{L+M-1} & c_{L+M} \\ 0^M & \cdots & 0 & 1 \end{vmatrix} = \begin{vmatrix} c_{L-M+1} & \cdots & c_L \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ c_L & \cdots & c_{L+M-1} \end{vmatrix}$$

Matrices (determinants resp.) of this type — that is with antidiagonals all constant — is called a Hankel matrices (Hankel determinants resp.). Since the Hankel determinants give a useful form for expressing some conditions of interest we will

define $H(n, m)$ to be the determinant of the $(m + 1) \times (m + 1)$ Hankel matrix with $c_n, \dots, c_{n+2m}$ in the antidiagonals,

$$H(n, m) := \begin{vmatrix} c_n & \cdots & c_{n+m} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ c_{n+m} & \cdots & c_{n+2m} \end{vmatrix}.$$

We can relate the two previous equations by

$$Q^{[L/M]}(0) = H(L - M + 1, M - 1)$$

so that the sufficient condition for the existence of $R^{[L/M]}(z)$ is $H(L - M + 1, M - 1) \neq 0$.

We now narrow our focus to Padé approximants to a Hamburger transform. Let μ be a Borel measure on $\mathbb{R}$ with finite moments $c_k = \int p^k d\mu$.

With the shape reconstruction application in mind, we will now assume the measure μ is absolutely continuous with respect to the Lebesgue measure and denote it $f(x)dx$ where $f(x)$ is some non-negative Lebesgue measurable function of $\mathbb{R}$. Note that by this assumption, μ cannot be supported on a finite set. The additional restriction that μ has infinite support turns out to be important when discussing the determinacy of μ .

Recall that the Hamburger transform of μ ,

$$g(z) := \int_{\mathbb{R}} \frac{d\mu}{1 + pz}$$

has the asymptotic expansion, in the sense of non-tangential limits,

$$g(z) \simeq \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} c_k (-z^k).$$

We call this formal power series a Hamburger series.

1.7.3 Lemma. The Hamburger moments c_k satisfy the determinantal condition $H(2n, m) \neq 0$ for $n, m = 0, 1, \dots$. That is,

$$\begin{vmatrix} c_{2n} & \cdots & c_{2n+m} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ c_{2n+m} & \cdots & c_{2n+2m} \end{vmatrix} \neq 0$$

Proof. Consider the bilinear quadratic form given by

$$G(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{y}) := \mathbf{x}^\top \begin{pmatrix} c_{2n} & \cdots & c_{2n+m} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ c_{2n+m} & \cdots & c_{2n+2m} \end{pmatrix} \mathbf{y}$$

If $\mathbf{x} = (x_0, x_1, \dots, x_m)^\top$ then

$$\begin{aligned}
G(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{x}) &= \sum_{i,j=0}^m x_i x_j c_{2n+i+j} \\
&= \sum_{i,j=0}^m x_i x_j \int p^{2n+i+j} d\mu \\
&= \int \sum_{i,j=0}^m x_i x_j p^{2n+i+j} d\mu \\
&= \int p^{2n} \left(\sum_{k=0}^m x_k p^k \right)^2 d\mu \geq 0.
\end{aligned}$$

Thus $G(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{y})$ is positive semi-definite. Furthermore, equality holds

$$\int p^{2n} \left(\sum_{k=0}^m x_k p^k \right)^2 d\mu = 0$$

if and only if μ is supported entirely on the zeros of the polynomial $p^n \sum_{k=0}^m x_k p^k$. However by assumption μ has infinite support. So in fact G is strictly positive definite. We conclude, by Sylvester's criterion for example, that associated Hankel matrix has positive determinant. That is, $H(2n, m) > 0$. $\square$

The previous lemma guarantees the existence of certain Padé approximants; specifically those with $L - M + 1$ even.

1.7.4 Proposition. If J is odd then the Padé approximant $R^{[L/L+J]}(z)$ to the Hamburger series exists in Baker's sense.

Let $R_M(z)$ be the off-diagonal $[M/M + 1]$ approximant to the Hamburger series of μ ,

$$R_M(z) = \frac{P_M(z)}{Q_M(z)} \approx \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} c_k (-z)^k$$

where $c_k = \int p^k f(p) dp$.

The following theorem, paraphrased from Baker ^{Bake81} [3], is central to the shape reconstruction method discussed in Chapter 3.

1.7.5 Definition. A family of continuous functions $\mathcal{F}$ is called **normal** if every sequence in $\mathcal{F}$ contains a subsequence which converges **locally uniformly**, that is, uniformly on compact sets.

1.7.6 Proposition. The off-diagonal Padé approximants $R_M(z)$ to a solvable Hamburger series $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} c_k (-z)^k$ form a normal family. The limit of a convergent

subsequence of approximants must have an integral representation

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{d\mu}{1+zp}$$

where μ is some Borel measure with moments c_k .

:determinacy

1.7.7 Corollary. If the moments c_k are determinate, then the off-diagonal approximants to the Hamburger series converge locally uniformly to the Hamburger transform of μ .

We discuss sufficient conditions for determinacy in section [1.2](#) and chapter [2](#). [sec:momentproblem](#) [chap:RTmoments](#)

sec:tensors

1.8 Symmetric tensors and polynomials

Let V be a finite dimensional real vector space with basis $\{e_1, e_2, \dots, e_n\}$. The tensor power $V^{\otimes k}$ is a real vector space, with basis

$$\{e_{i_1} \otimes e_{i_2} \otimes \dots \otimes e_{i_k}\}_{(i_1, \dots, i_k) \in \{1, \dots, n\}^k}$$

By convention we order this basis lexicographically. For example in the case $n = 3, k = 2$,

$$\begin{aligned} &\{e_1 \otimes e_1, e_1 \otimes e_2, e_1 \otimes e_3, \\ &\quad e_2 \otimes e_1, e_2 \otimes e_2, e_2 \otimes e_3, \\ &\quad e_3 \otimes e_1, e_3 \otimes e_2, e_3 \otimes e_3, \} \end{aligned}$$

For convenience we will use the vector notation $\mathbf{e} = (e_1, \dots, e_n)$ for the basis of V and

$$\mathbf{e}_{\otimes i} = e_{i_1} \otimes e_{i_2} \otimes \dots \otimes e_{i_k}$$

for the elements of the induced basis of $V^{\otimes k}$, where $i = (i_1, i_2, \dots, i_k) \in \{1, 2, \dots, n\}^k$. There is a natural embedding $V^k \hookrightarrow V^{\otimes k}$ given by

$$(v_1, v_2, \dots, v_k) \mapsto v_1 \otimes v_2 \otimes \dots \otimes v_k$$

and the tensor power satisfies the following universal property: Any “multilinear” map out of V^k can be factored as a linear map out of $V^{\otimes k}$ composed with the inclusion above.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} V^k & \hookrightarrow & V^{\otimes k} \\ & \searrow & \downarrow \\ & & W \end{array}$$

Given a linear transformation $T : V \rightarrow V$, the tensor power $T^{\otimes k}$ is the unique

linear map $V^{\otimes k} \rightarrow V^{\otimes k}$ such that

$$T^{\otimes k}(\mathbf{e}_{\otimes i}) = (Te_{i_1}) \otimes \cdots \otimes (Te_{i_k}).$$

In the basis $\{\mathbf{e}_{\otimes i}\}$ ordered lexicographically the matrix representation for $T^{\otimes k}$ is given explicitly by the k -fold Kronecker product of the matrix for T in the basis $\mathbf{e}$. Tensor powers of linear maps commute with transposes

$$(T^{\otimes k})^\top = (T^\top)^{\otimes k}$$

If V has an inner product $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle_V$ then an inner product on $V^{\otimes k}$ can be defined by

$$\langle \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i}, \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i'} \rangle_{V^{\otimes k}} = \langle e_{i_1}, e_{i'_1} \rangle_V \cdots \langle e_{i_k}, e_{i'_k} \rangle_V.$$

We will generally omit the subscripts and write $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle$ for either inner product, determined from context. For any linear transformation $T : V \rightarrow V$ we have

$$\langle T^{\otimes k}(\mathbf{e}_{\otimes i}), \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i'} \rangle = \langle \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i}, (T^\top)^{\otimes k}(\mathbf{e}_{\otimes i'}) \rangle.$$

In particular for an orthogonal transformation $R \in O(n)$ on $\mathbb{R}^n$ we have

$$\langle R^{\otimes k}(\mathbf{e}_{\otimes i}), \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i'} \rangle = \langle \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i}, (R^{-1})^{\otimes k}(\mathbf{e}_{\otimes i'}) \rangle$$

and for a projection P ,

$$\langle P^{\otimes k} \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i}, \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i'} \rangle = \langle \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i}, P^{\otimes k} \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i'} \rangle.$$

Note that

$$\langle T^{\otimes k}(\mathbf{e}_{\otimes i}), \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i'} \rangle = \langle Te_{i_1}, e_{i'_1} \rangle \cdots \langle Te_{i_k}, e_{i'_k} \rangle = T_{i_1, i'_1} \cdots T_{i_k, i'_k}$$

is a product of entries in the matrix representation for T with basis $\mathbf{e}$.

The inner product allows for a convenient expression of polynomials. Henceforth we take $V = \mathbb{R}^n$. For $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$ a multi index $\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n$ of degree $|\alpha| = k$ we have

$$x^\alpha = x_1^{\alpha_1} x_2^{\alpha_2} \cdots x_n^{\alpha_n} = \prod_{i=1}^n \langle x, e_i \rangle^{\alpha_i} = \langle x^{\otimes k}, \mathbf{e}^{\otimes \alpha} \rangle$$

where we write

$$x^{\otimes k} = \underbrace{x \otimes x \otimes \cdots \otimes x}_{k \text{ times}}$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{e}^{\otimes \alpha} &= e_1^{\otimes \alpha_1} \otimes \cdots \otimes e_n^{\otimes \alpha_n} \\ &= \underbrace{e_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes e_1}_{\alpha_1 \text{ times}} \otimes \cdots \otimes \underbrace{e_n \otimes \cdots \otimes e_n}_{\alpha_n \text{ times}} \end{aligned}$$

For example, in $\mathbb{R}^3$ the monomial $x^{(1,1,2)} = x_1 x_2 x_3^2$ can be written

$$x_1 x_2 x_3^2 = \langle x \otimes x \otimes x \otimes x, e_1 \otimes e_2 \otimes e_3 \otimes e_3 \rangle$$

Now this monomial representation is not unique. Indeed, since the tensor inner product is given as a product of euclidean products, we may as well imagine $\mathbf{e}^{\otimes \alpha}$ to be commutative. More precisely, for any permutation $\sigma \in S_k$ we have equivalently,

$$\langle x^{\otimes k}, \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i} \rangle = \langle x^{\otimes k}, e_{\sigma^{-1}i_1} \otimes \cdots \otimes e_{\sigma^{-1}i_k} \rangle$$

for any $i \in \{1, \dots, n\}^k$. The basis $\{\mathbf{e}_{\otimes i}\}_{i \in \{1, \dots, n\}^k}$ can be partitioned by equivalence under permutation to $\mathbf{e}^{\otimes \alpha}$ for each degree k multiindex α . Let

$$I(\alpha) = \{i \in \{1, \dots, n\}^k : \langle x^{\otimes k}, \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i} \rangle = \langle x^{\otimes k}, \mathbf{e}^{\otimes \alpha} \rangle\}$$

One can check that $\{I(\alpha)\}_{|\alpha|=k}$ is a partition of the k -tuples $\{1, \dots, n\}^k$. For example with $n = 2, k = 2$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} x_1^2 &= \langle x \otimes x, e_1 \otimes e_1 \rangle \\ x_1 x_2 &= \langle x \otimes x, e_1 \otimes e_2 \rangle = \langle x \otimes x, e_2 \otimes e_1 \rangle \\ x_2^2 &= \langle x \otimes x, e_2 \otimes e_2 \rangle \end{aligned}$$

Thus it seems more appropriate to write monomials in terms of “commutative” symmetric tensors. We define the symmetrization of a basis tensor $\mathbf{e}_{\otimes i}$ by averaging over permutations

$$P_s \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i} := \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} e_{\sigma i_1} \otimes \cdots \otimes e_{\sigma i_k}.$$

which can be seen as an orthogonal projection onto the subspace of symmetric tensors (tensors invariant under permutation).

The subspace of k -tensors invariant under permutation of indices is denoted $V^{\odot k} \subseteq V^{\otimes k}$. Elements may be defined by the projection,

$$v_1 \odot v_2 \odot \cdots \odot v_k = \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} v_{\sigma 1} \otimes v_{\sigma 2} \otimes \cdots \otimes v_{\sigma k}.$$

The non-decreasing tuples $i = (i_1, \dots, i_k) \in \{1, \dots, n\}^k$ indexes a standard basis,

$$\mathbf{e}_{\odot i} := e_{i_1} \odot \cdots \odot e_{i_k}, \quad 1 \leq i_1 \leq \cdots \leq i_k \leq n.$$

Even better, there is a one to one correspondence between non-decreasing k -tuples and multi-indices of degree k ,

$$\tilde{\alpha} = (\underbrace{1, \dots, 1}_{\alpha_1 \text{ times}}, \underbrace{2, \dots, 2}_{\alpha_2 \text{ times}}, \dots, \underbrace{n, \dots, n}_{\alpha_n \text{ times}})$$

so we may write the basis

$$\mathbf{e}^{\odot \alpha} := e_1^{\odot \alpha_1} \odot \cdots \odot e_n^{\odot \alpha_n}, \quad \alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n, |\alpha| = k$$

The k -tensor inner product restricted to $V^{\odot k}$ says

$$\begin{aligned} \langle v_1 \odot \cdots \odot v_k, w_1 \odot \cdots \odot w_k \rangle &= \sum_{\sigma_1, \sigma_2 \in S_k} \prod \langle v_{\sigma_1 j}, w_{\sigma_2 j} \rangle \\ &= \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} \prod \langle v_{\sigma j}, w_j \rangle \\ &= \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} \prod \langle v, w_{\sigma j} \rangle. \end{aligned}$$

Now the monomial expression in terms of symmetric tensors takes the simple form

$$x^\alpha = \langle x^{\odot k}, \mathbf{e}^{\odot \alpha} \rangle.$$

Taken further, the correspondence between homogeneous polynomials of degree k and symmetric k -tensors can be shown to be a vector space isomorphism, and extended to an isomorphism between the entire polynomial space and the graded space formed by symmetric tensors of all orders.

Chapter 2

Moments of the RT and GRT

chap:RTmoments

In this chapter we discuss some necessary conditions for the the determinacy of certain multivariate moment problems by way of the Radon and Gaussian Radon transforms.

2.1 Projection moments and Petersen's theorem

2.1.1 Proposition. Let $c_k(\omega) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} R_f(\omega, p) p^k dp$ be the projection moments of f in a fixed direction $\omega \in S^{n-1}$, where $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ has finite multivariate moments c_α . Then

$$c_k(\omega) = \sum_{|\alpha|=k} \binom{k}{\alpha} \omega^\alpha c_\alpha$$

where $\binom{k}{\alpha} = \frac{k!}{\alpha_1! \alpha_2! \cdots \alpha_n!}$ are multinomial coefficients.

Proof. By the slice theorem (I.4.2) with $F(p) = p^k$,

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} R_f(\omega, p) p^k dp = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) \langle x, \omega \rangle^k dx.$$

Now $\langle x, \omega \rangle^k = (x_1 \omega_1 + \cdots + x_n \omega_n)^k$ has the multinomial expansion

$$\langle x, \omega \rangle^k = \sum_{|\alpha|=k} \binom{k}{\alpha} x^\alpha \omega^\alpha.$$

Thus after a bit of rearranging we get

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) \langle x, \omega \rangle^k dx &= \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) \sum_{|\alpha|=k} \binom{k}{\alpha} x^\alpha \omega^\alpha dx \\ &= \sum_{|\alpha|=k} \binom{k}{\alpha} \omega^\alpha \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) x^\alpha dx, \end{aligned}$$

where the integrands are precisely the k th degree multivariate moments of f . $\square$

Similarly, moments of the GRT (Gaussian projection moments) can be expressed in terms of multivariate gaussian moments.

2.1.2 Proposition. Let $c_k^\gamma(\omega) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} GR_f(\omega, p) p^k \gamma(p) dp$ be the Gaussian moments of the GRT of f at a fixed ω , where $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ has finite Gaussian multivariate moments $c_\alpha^\gamma = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) \gamma_n(x) x^\alpha dx$. Then

$$c_k^\gamma(\omega) = \sum_{|\alpha|=k} \binom{k}{\alpha} \omega^\alpha c_\alpha^\gamma.$$

Proof. The proof follows as it did for the RT. This time we apply the GRT slice theorem (1.4.3) ^{ed:GSI} with $F(p) = p^k$,

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} GR_f(\omega, p) p^k \gamma(p) dp = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) \langle x, \omega \rangle^k \gamma_n(x) dx$$

Again we use the multinomial expansion of $\langle x, \omega \rangle^n$ and rearrange:

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) \langle x, \omega \rangle^k \gamma_n(x) dx = \sum_{|\alpha|=k} \binom{k}{\alpha} \omega^\alpha \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) \gamma_n(x) x^\alpha dx.$$

Thus

$$c_k^\gamma(\omega) = \sum_{|\alpha|=k} \binom{k}{\alpha} \omega^\alpha c_\alpha^\gamma.$$

□

2.1.3 Example. Let $e_1, e_2, \dots, e_n \in S^{n-1}$ be the the standard basis for $\mathbb{R}^n$,

$$(1, 0, \dots, 0), (0, 1, \dots, 0), \dots, (0, 0, \dots, 1)$$

Then $\langle x, e_i \rangle = x_i$ is the natural projection of $\mathbb{R}^n$ onto the e_i axis. The standard projection moments can be calculated as follows

$$\begin{aligned} c_k(e_i) &= \sum_{|\alpha|=k} \binom{k}{\alpha} e_i^\alpha c_\alpha \\ &= c_{ke_i} \end{aligned}$$

since $e_i^\alpha = 0$ unless $\alpha = ke_i$.

The following theorem, due to Petersen ^{Pete82} [18], gives a way us to reduce the question of determinacy for multivariate moment problems to the classical case.

2.1.4 Proposition (Petersen's theorem). Let μ be a Borel measure with finite moments on $\mathbb{R}^n$, and $e_1, \dots, e_n$ the standard basis for $\mathbb{R}^n$. If each $R_\mu^{e_1}, \dots, R_\mu^{e_n}$ is determinate as a measure on $\mathbb{R}$, then μ is determinate.

Proof. An outline of the proof is as follows: Preliminarily, note that the solution set $[\mu]$ of Borel measures with equivalent moments to μ is convex, and μ is an extreme point in $[\mu]$ if and only if polynomials are dense in $L^1(\mathbb{R}^n, \mu)$ [27]. Thus it suffices to show that polynomials are dense in $L^1(\mathbb{R}^n, \mu')$ for any $\mu' \in [\mu]$. A2d21

The family of products of continuous functions of compact support $f(x) = \prod_{i=1}^n f_i(x_i)$ where each $f_i \in C_c(\mathbb{R})$, is dense in $L^1(\mu)$. Furthermore, since $R_\mu^{e_i}$, $i = 1, \dots, n$ are determinate, polynomials are dense in each $L^2(\mathbb{R}, R_\mu^{e_i})$. Petersen constructs a series of polynomials $P_i : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that the polynomial product $P(x) = \prod_{i=1}^n P_i(x_i)$ arbitrarily close to f in $L^1(\mu)$. Thus polynomials are dense in $L^1(\mathbb{R}^n, \mu)$ and the moment problem is determinate. $\square$

2.1.5 Remark. Petersen's theorem is not basis dependent. Indeed, given an orthonormal basis $\tilde{e}_1, \dots, \tilde{e}_n \in \mathbb{R}^n$, the orthogonal matrix R defined by $Re_i = \tilde{e}_i$, $i = 1, \dots, n$, induces a one-to-one mapping between moment net c_α and the moment net $\tilde{c}_\alpha$ given by

$$\tilde{c}_\alpha = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) \sum_{i=1}^n \langle x, \tilde{e}_i \rangle dx$$

2.1.6 Corollary. If μ is compactly supported Borel measure on $\mathbb{R}^n$, then the multivariate moment problem is determinate.

2.2 Determinate Gaussian projection moments

We show in section (1.2) that any function f in the weighted space $L^2(\gamma)$ has determinate Gaussian moments. By Petersen's theorem if $GR_f(e_i, \cdot)$ has determinate Gaussian moments for each $i = 1, \dots, n$ then the function $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ has determinate Gaussian moments. For the purposes of the shape reconstruction method we note that the GRT of an indicator function is bounded,

$$GR_f(\omega, p) = \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = p} f(x) \gamma_{n-1}(x - p\omega) dx \leq \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = p} \gamma_{n-1}(x - p\omega) dx = 1,$$

thus all measurable sets have determinate Gaussian moments. We make a stronger claim:

2.2.1 Theorem. If $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ is measurable and

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^n} |f(x)|^2 \gamma_n(x) dx < \infty,$$

then the Gaussian moments of $GR_f(\omega, p)$ given by

$$c_k^\gamma(\omega) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} GR_f(\omega, p) p^k \gamma(p) dp$$

are determinate for any $\omega \in S^{n-1}$, and as a consequence the Gaussian moments of f are determinate.

Proof. Fix $\omega \in S^{n-1}$. By the Cauchy-Schwarz inequality,

$$|GR_f(\omega, p)|^2 \leq \int_{\langle \omega, x \rangle = p} |f(x)|^2 \gamma_{n-1}(x - p\omega) \, dx.$$

Thus by the Gaussian slice theorem

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |GR_f(\omega, p)|^2 \gamma(p) \, dp &\leq \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = p} |f(x)|^2 \gamma_{n-1}(x - p\omega) \, dx \, \gamma(p) \, dp \\ &= \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} |f(x)|^2 \gamma_n(x) \, dx < \infty. \end{aligned}$$

Since $GR_f(\omega, p) \in L^2(\gamma(p))$ the determinacy of the Gaussian projection moments follows. By Petersen's theorem, the Gaussian moments of f are determinate. $\square$

Chapter 3

Shape reconstruction from moments

In this chapter we describe a method for shape reconstruction from moments and propose an extension of the method to unbounded regions. In the first section we summarize the method for bounded sets. This is the work of Cuyt et al. [9] which we extend in the following sections to unbounded shapes and positive functions of at most polynomial growth. The methods all each have the basic structure:

- (i) From moments of f compute Padé approximants to its Stieltjes transform.
- (ii) Choosing a set of nodes on which to approximate f , construct an appropriate cubature formula to the Stieltjes transform.
- (iii) Solve — or approximate a solution to — the linear system given by equating the Padé approximants and cubature formula.

3.1 Reconstruction of bounded shapes

Suppose $A \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$ is a bounded measurable set with indicator function f . Then it has finite multivariate moments

$$c_\alpha = \int_A x^\alpha dx.$$

The projection moments for any $\omega \in S^{n-1}$, given by

$$c_k(\omega) = \sum_{|\alpha|=k} \binom{k}{\alpha} c_\alpha \omega^\alpha$$

are coefficients to the Stieltjes series

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} c_k(\omega) (-z)^k,$$

which converges in a neighborhood of $z = 0$ to the Stieltjes transform

$$g_\omega(z) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{R_A(\omega, p)}{1 + pz} dp = \int_A \frac{1}{1 + z \langle x, \omega \rangle} dx.$$

Note that since A is bounded, say by $\|x\| \leq r$ for all $x \in A$, then $RT_A(\omega, p)$ vanishes for $|p| > r$. Singularities in the integrand can only occur when $z = -1/p$ so we conclude $g_\omega(z)$ is well defined for $|z| < 1/r$.

Recall that since A is bounded, it has determinate multivariate moments and projection moments. By corollary [1.7.7](#), $g_\omega(z)$ is the uniform limit of the off-diagonal Padé approximants $R_M(z)$ to the Stieltjes series. The rate of convergence in this case is known, and can be found in [\[3\]](#).

We consider $g_\omega(z)$ as the restriction of the multivariate Stieltjes transform

$$g(y) = \int_A \frac{1}{1 + \langle x, y \rangle} dx, \quad y \in \mathbb{R}^n$$

to a the linear span of $\omega \in S^{n-1}$. That is, for $z \in \mathbb{R}$,

$$g(z\omega) = \int_A \frac{1}{1 + z \langle x, \omega \rangle} dx = g_\omega(z).$$

Here $g(z\omega)$ is well defined for $|z| < 1/r$ so that the multivariate transform is well defined for $\|y\| < 1/r$. For any $y \in \mathbb{R}^n$, we can compute projection moments with $\omega = y/\|y\|$, from which we can approximate $g(y) = g_\omega(\|y\|)$ by way of the Padé approximants described above. Let us denote this approximation by $\tilde{g}(y)$.

Now suppose $g(y)$ can be simultaneously approximated by a cubature formula

$$\sum_{i=0}^I w_i(y) f(x_i) \approx \int_A \frac{1}{1 + \langle x, y \rangle} dx,$$

where $f(x) = 1_A(x)$. Consider the linear system,

$$\sum_{i=0}^I w_i(y_j) \tilde{f}_i = \tilde{g}(y_j), \quad j = 0, \dots, J$$

where $y_0, \dots, y_J \in \mathbb{R}^n$ are a set of distinct sample points with $y_i < 1/r$ and $J > I$. At least heuristically, we expect a solution to this system in the form of the values to approximate the values of the characteristic function

$$\tilde{f}_i \approx f(x_i), \quad i = 0, \dots, I,$$

at the cubature nodes x_i . Thus, if for example, we use a cubature formula with nodes x_i on a finite integer lattice around A , we will have computed an approximate pixel image of A .

Our discussion thus far clearly avoided some technical details. The choice of cubature formula and well-posedness of the linear system are obvious concerns, which we touch on briefly in section [3.4](#).

3.2 Reconstruction of unbounded shapes

Our proposed extension to the method above follows roughly the same trajectory, but applies to a much broader class of functions. We will start with the prime example of indicator functions of unbounded measurable sets, and discuss the generalization in the next section.

Let $A \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$ be a measurable set with indicator function f . Then f necessarily has finite Gaussian moments,

$$c_\alpha^\gamma = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) x^\alpha \gamma_n(x) dx.$$

The Gaussian projection moments for any $\omega \in S^{n-1}$ are given by

$$c_k^\gamma(\omega) = \sum_{|\alpha|=k} \binom{k}{\alpha} c_\alpha^\gamma \omega^\alpha.$$

Now the Stieltjes series

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} c_k^\gamma(\omega) (-z)^k$$

is generally formal. Likewise, the Stieltjes transform

$$g_\omega^\gamma(z) := \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{GR_A(\omega, p)}{1 + pz} \gamma(p) dp = \int_A \frac{1}{1 + z \langle x, \omega \rangle} \gamma_n(x) dx$$

may be undefined on the real line, but is analytic on the half planes $\text{Im } z \neq 0$. In this case the Stieltjes series is an asymptotic expansion to the Stieltjes transform in the sense of nontangential convergence,

$$g_\omega^\gamma(z) \simeq \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} c_k^\gamma(\omega) (-z)^k.$$

For more details on the Stieltjes series and transform in the case of Hamburger moments see section [1.6](#).

Now we note that $GR_A(\omega, p)$ is a bounded function, so that the Gaussian projection moments are determinate. Thus, as discussed in section [1.7](#), the $[M - 1/M]$ Padé approximants to the Stieltjes series converge locally uniformly on the half planes to the Stieltjes transform.

Once again, we view $g_\omega^\gamma(z)$ as a restriction of a multivariate Stieltjes transform. Following the lead of the previous method, we consider the function $g^\gamma : \mathbb{C}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^n$ given by the integral representation

$$g^\gamma(y) = \int_A \frac{1}{1 + \langle x, y \rangle} \gamma_n(x) dx$$

whenever well defined. Here $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle$ is the standard inner product on $\mathbb{C}^n$. We have seen that $g^\gamma(y)$ exists when $y = z\omega$ for $\omega \in S^{n-1}$ and $z \in \mathbb{C}$ has nonzero imaginary part,

$$g^\gamma(z\omega) = \int_A \frac{1}{1 + z \langle x, y \rangle} \gamma_n(x) \, dx = g_\omega^\gamma(z)$$

(We assume the complex inner product is conjugate linear in the first variable and linear in the second for simplicity).

Again, suppose $g^\gamma(y)$ can be simultaneously approximated by a cubature formula

$$\sum_{i=0}^I w_i(y) f^\gamma(x_i) \approx \int_A \frac{1}{1 + \langle x, y \rangle} \gamma_n(x) \, dx,$$

where $f^\gamma(x) = 1_A(x) \gamma_n(x)$. Consider the linear system,

$$\sum_{i=0}^I w_i(y_j) \tilde{f}_i^\gamma = \tilde{g}^\gamma(y_j), \quad j = 0, \dots, J$$

where $y_0, \dots, y_J \in \mathbb{C}^n$ are a set of distinct sample points and $J > I$. In this case we require our sample points to take the form $y = z\omega$ sufficient for the existence of $g^\gamma(y)$. At least heuristically, we expect a solution to this system in the form of the values to approximate the values

$$\tilde{f}_i^\gamma \approx f^\gamma(x_i), \quad i = 0, \dots, I,$$

at the cubature nodes x_i . In order to approximate A we simply remove the Gaussian weight,

$$\frac{\tilde{f}_i^\gamma}{\gamma_n(x_i)} \approx \frac{f^\gamma(x_i)}{\gamma_n(x_i)} = 1_A(x_i).$$

Here we may still use a finite lattice to produce a pixel image, but importantly neither the sample points y_i nor the Padé approximant $\tilde{g}^\gamma$ depend on the choice of cubature formula. In other words, with $\tilde{g}^\gamma(y_j)$ precomputed, image approximations to A can — in theory — be constructed for arbitrary pixel grids. We suspect that careful choice of cubature formulas may lead to additional redundancy in computing the weights $w_i(y_j)$.

3.3 Reconstruction of functions in weighted L^2 space

As discussed in section ^{|sec:GRTdeterminacy|}2.2, the Gaussian moments of a function in the weighted space $L^2(\gamma_n)$ are determinate. Thus the method for unbounded shape reconstruction evidently applies just as well to all measurable functions $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow [0, \infty)$

which satisfy

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x)^2 \gamma_n(x) dx < \infty.$$

We will not repeat the construction, but in short, the Gaussian Moments

$$c_\alpha^\gamma = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) x^\alpha \gamma_n(x) dx \quad \alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n$$

can be used to approximate a multivariate Stieltjes transform

$$g(y) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} \frac{f(x)}{1 + \langle x, y \rangle} \gamma_n(x) dx$$

where $y \in \mathbb{C}^n$ is required to take a specific form. Simultaneously approximating $g(y)$ by a cubature formula, we form a linear system for which approximate values of f on the cubature nodes is a solution.

3.4 Implementation and practical limitations

c:implementation

Here we will briefly discuss some of the computational aspects in implementation of the shape reconstruction methods. The following discussion is based on a series of examples tested in Mathematica, and is not intended to be rigorous.

To the best of our knowledge, no rigorous analysis of the presented methods from a numerical or computational perspective exist. Nor are we qualified to undertake such an analysis ourselves. Of the most obvious concerns are the accuracy of the cubature approximation, the solvability of the high dimensional linear system, and stability with respect to errors in moments.

While any sufficiently accurate cubature formula should work, those with nodes on a uniform cubic lattice – trapazoid and Simpson’s formulas, e.g. – have the benefit of producing an approximation easily visualized as a grayscale pixel image. Product formulas formed from compound Gaussian quadrature rules should also be considered. Indeed the examples in [9] are computed using a compound two-point Gauss-Legendre formula. Such cubature formulas have nodes on a “nearly” uniform cubic grid, leading to some distortion when viewed as an image, however the distortion scales down as image resolution increases.

For the proposed extensions to the method, we suggest a product Gauss-Hermite formula, whose nodes are given by the cartesian product of the zeros of a Hermite polynomial. This is a natural choice for numerical integration with a Gaussian weight. Importantly, we expect a good degree of accuracy due to the density of polynomials in $L^2(\gamma_n)$. Furthermore the zeros of Hermite polynomials have roughly uniform spacing, and it is common practice to “prune” the nodes furthest from the origin where spacing is most distorted. The nodes and weights for

Gauss-Hermite cubature can be computed efficiently even for high degrees. For increasing degree, we get smaller spacing over a larger neighborhood.

In experiments we have found the most computationally intensive portion of the method to be the formation and solving of the linear system. Unsurprisingly, for even the mildest examples, this system tends to be highly dimensional and generally ill-determined. The authors of [9] suggest using a truncated singular value decomposition, discarding singular values below a threshold. We have had reasonable success via Mathematica's PsuedoInverse method. We should also note that the introduction of non-real terms in the proposed methods presents some additional complications. In particular, approximate solutions tend to be complex valued.

Finally, we should discuss the elephant in the room. The discrete reconstructions formed by our methods are necessarily finite, which is at odds to their utility as approximations to unbounded objects. One might propose instead applying the method for bounded shape reconstruction where we restrict unbounded objects to some bounded region. We argue that even in constructing a finite approximation, there is some benefit to working with global information. Assuming one has access to the Gaussian moments, it is convenient that our method does not impose an arbitrary restriction on the scale of the object. Consider a situation where we would like to construct a series of improving approximations to an unbounded object. Since the approximate sample values $\tilde{g}^\gamma(y_j)$ can be precomputed (and further sample points y_j can be added at little cost), we are able to increase both the overall size of the approximation as well as the granularity of node spacing without much adjustment.

There is much more to be said on the practical limitations of these methods, but as we have hopefully shown, their theoretical foundation is solid and there is good reason to expect them to work in practice. Further investigation into the questions of numerical stability and computational efficiency is needed.

Chapter 4

The Gaussian Radon transform of polynomials

Unlike the Radon transform, the Gaussian Radon transform is well defined on polynomials. In this chapter we investigate the GRT from this perspective, as a linear operator between polynomial spaces. In particular we prove a simple formula for the GRT of multivariate Hermite polynomials. We extend this result to some generalizations of the GRT.

We begin this chapter by proving a formula for the GRT of the multivariate Hermite polynomials.

4.1 The GRT of multivariate Hermite polynomials

Recall that for $\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n$ the polynomials $H_\alpha(x)$ can be defined by the generating function

$$e^{\langle x, y \rangle - \frac{\|y\|^2}{2}} = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n} \frac{H_\alpha(x)}{\alpha!} y^\alpha$$

where $\alpha! = \alpha_1! \cdots \alpha_n!$. These are related to the classical Hermite polynomials by

$$H_\alpha(x) = \prod_{i=1}^n H_{\alpha_i}(x_i)$$

where, for $k \in \mathbb{N}_0^\infty$, the classical polynomials $H_k(p)$ can be defined by

$$e^{pt - \frac{t^2}{2}} = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{H_k(p)}{k!} t^k.$$

prop:GRTHermite **4.1.1 Proposition.** Let $\omega \in S^{n-1}$ and $p \in \mathbb{R}$ be fixed. If $|\alpha| = k$, then the GRT of the multivariate Hermite polynomial H_α is

$$GR_{H_\alpha}(\omega, p) = H_k(p) \omega^\alpha \tag{4.1.1} \span style="border: 1px solid black; padding: 2px;">eq:GRH$$

Proof. Recall that the generating function $\phi(x) = e^{\langle x, y \rangle - \frac{\|y\|^2}{2}}$ converges absolutely

for all $x, y \in \mathbb{R}^n$. Consider the GRT of ϕ ,

$$GR_\phi(\omega, p) = \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = p} \phi(x) \gamma_{n-1}(x - p\omega) \, dx.$$

Immediately we can expand $\phi(x)$, interchanging integral and series, to see

$$\begin{aligned} GR_\phi(\omega, p) &= \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n} \frac{1}{\alpha!} y^\alpha \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = p} H_\alpha(x) \gamma_{n-1}(x - p\omega) \, dx \\ &= \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n} \frac{GR_{H_\alpha}(\omega, p)}{\alpha!} y^\alpha. \end{aligned} \tag{4.1.2} \quad \boxed{\text{eq:GRTPhiExp1}}$$

On the other hand, we will be able to show that

$$GR_\phi(\omega, p) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \sum_{|\alpha|=k} \frac{H_k(p)\omega^\alpha}{\alpha!} y^\alpha. \tag{4.1.3} \quad \boxed{\text{eq:GRTPhiExp2}}$$

Thus, being careful to note that the series (4.1.2) and (4.1.3) converge absolutely, we can compare coefficients for the desired formula. In order to derive the second expansion we begin by translating our integral onto the linear subspace $\langle x, \omega \rangle = 0$, via the change of variables $x \mapsto x + p\omega$:

$$\begin{aligned} GR_\phi(\omega, p) &= \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = 0} \phi(x + p\omega) \gamma_{n-1}(x) \, dx \\ &= \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = 0} e^{\langle x + p\omega, y \rangle - \frac{\|y\|^2}{2}} (2\pi)^{-\frac{n-1}{2}} e^{-\frac{\|x\|^2}{2}} \, dx \\ &= e^{p\langle \omega, y \rangle - \frac{\|y\|^2}{2}} \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = 0} e^{\langle x, y \rangle - \frac{\|x\|^2}{2}} (2\pi)^{-\frac{n-1}{2}} \, dx \end{aligned} \tag{4.1.4} \quad \boxed{\text{eq:GRTPhiExp3}}$$

Now in order to compute the right side integral we consider the orthogonal decomposition $y = y_\omega + y_{\omega^\perp}$, where

$$y_\omega = \langle y, \omega \rangle \omega \quad y_{\omega^\perp} = y - y_\omega.$$

We make two observations about this decomposition of y : First,

$$\|y\|^2 = \|y_\omega\|^2 + \|y_{\omega^\perp}\|^2 = \langle y, \omega \rangle^2 + \|y_{\omega^\perp}\|^2 \tag{4.1.5} \quad \boxed{\text{eq:GRTPhiExp4}}$$

and second, for x in the linear subspace $\langle x, \omega \rangle = 0$ we have

$$\langle x, y \rangle = \langle x, \omega \rangle \langle y, \omega \rangle + \langle x, y_{\omega^\perp} \rangle = \langle x, y_{\omega^\perp} \rangle.$$

This second observation allows us to solve the integral at the end of (4.1.4). By eq:GRTPhiExpansion21

completing the square $\|x - y_{\omega^\perp}\|^2 = \|y_{\omega^\perp}\|^2 - 2\langle x, y_{\omega^\perp} \rangle + \|x\|^2$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = 0} e^{\langle x, y \rangle - \frac{\|x\|^2}{2}} (2\pi)^{-\frac{n-1}{2}} dx &= e^{-\frac{\|y_{\omega^\perp}\|^2}{2}} \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = 0} e^{-\frac{\|y_{\omega^\perp}\|^2}{2} + \langle x, y_{\omega^\perp} \rangle - \frac{\|x\|^2}{2}} (2\pi)^{-\frac{n-1}{2}} dx \\ &= e^{-\frac{\|y_{\omega^\perp}\|^2}{2}} \int_{\langle x, \omega \rangle = 0} e^{-\frac{\|x - y_{\omega^\perp}\|^2}{2}} (2\pi)^{-\frac{n-1}{2}} dx \end{aligned}$$

which is just $e^{-\frac{\|y_{\omega^\perp}\|^2}{2}}$. It was important here to invoke the orthogonal projection $y_{\omega^\perp}$ so that the integrand becomes the translation of a standard Gaussian function on the hyperplane $\langle x, \omega \rangle = 0$. Now returning to [eq:GRPhiExpansion1](#) (4.1.4), we have

$$\begin{aligned} GR_\phi(\omega, p) &= e^{p\langle \omega, y \rangle - \frac{\|y\|^2}{2} - \frac{\|y_{\omega^\perp}\|^2}{2}} \\ &= e^{p\langle \omega, y \rangle - \frac{\langle y, \omega \rangle^2}{2}} \end{aligned}$$

where we used [eq:GRTPhiExpansion2](#) (4.1.5). This looks like the generating function for the univariate Hermite polynomials $H_k(p)$ with $t = \langle \omega, y \rangle$, so we expand

$$GR_\phi(\omega, p) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{H_k(p)}{k!} \langle \omega, y \rangle^k.$$

Finally we apply the multinomial expansion of $\langle \omega, y \rangle^k$, recalling the multinomial coefficients $\binom{k}{\alpha} = \frac{k!}{\alpha!}$. Therefore

$$\begin{aligned} GR_\phi(\omega, p) &= \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \sum_{|\alpha|=k} \frac{H_k(p)}{k!} \binom{k}{\alpha} y^\alpha \omega^\alpha \\ &= \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \sum_{|\alpha|=k} \frac{H_k(p) \omega^\alpha}{\alpha!} y^\alpha \end{aligned}$$

as needed. □

4.1.2 Remark. The proof above was written by Dr. Sengupta. Recall that the Hermite polynomials H_α form a complete orthogonal basis for $L^2(\mathbb{R}^n, \gamma_n)$. In this sense the formula [eq:GRH](#) (4.1.1) completely defines the Gaussian Radon transform on this space. Indeed, it can be shown that any function $f \in L^2(\mathbb{R}^n, \gamma_n)$ has an expansion

$$f(x) = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n} a_\alpha^{(f)} H_\alpha(x)$$

where

$$a_\alpha^{(f)} = \int_{\mathbb{R}^n} f(x) H_\alpha(x) \gamma_n(x) dx.$$

If this expansion converges nicely on Λ then

$$\begin{aligned}
GR_f(\Lambda) &= \int_{\Lambda} f(x) \gamma_n(x - p_0) \, dx \\
&= \int_{\Lambda} \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n} a_{\alpha}^{(f)} H_{\alpha}(x) \gamma_n(x - p_0) \, dx \\
&= \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n} a_{\alpha}^{(f)} \int_{\Lambda} H_{\alpha}(x) \gamma_n(x - p_0) \, dx \\
&= \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n} a_{\alpha}^{(f)} GR_{H_{\alpha}}(\Lambda)
\end{aligned}$$

If Λ is a hyperplane $\langle x, \omega \rangle = p$ with $\omega \in S^{n-1}$ then this gives

$$\begin{aligned}
GR_f(\Lambda) &= \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n} a_{\alpha}^{(f)} GR_{H_{\alpha}}(\Lambda) \\
&= \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n} a_{\alpha}^{(f)} H_{|\alpha|}(p) \omega^{\alpha} \\
&= \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} H_k(p) \sum_{|\alpha|=k} a_{\alpha}^{(f)} \omega^{\alpha}
\end{aligned}$$

For details on modes convergence see [DuXu01](#) or [Than93](#) [\[11\]](#) or [\[25\]](#).

4.2 The GRT of multivariate polynomials over general affine subspaces

In section 1.4 we defined the RT and GRT as the integrals of a function $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ over $n - 1$ dimensional hyperplanes, the standard definitions. But there are many examples of geometric integral transforms, closely related to the hyperplane RT, which can be thought of as “generalized Radon transforms”. In fact, the “Funk transform”, which relates a function on the sphere S^3 to its integrals over great circles, was first introduced by Paul Funk in 1911, half a decade before Radon introduced the hyperplane RT. In the remainder of this chapter we discuss the notion of the RT and GRT on general d -dimensional affine subspaces of $\mathbb{R}^n$, where $d = 0, \dots, n$. For context, note that when $d = 1$, this is the so called “X-ray transform” which gets its name from the direct application to radiology.

Let Λ_0 be a d -dimensional linear subspace of $\mathbb{R}^n$, and $v \in \mathbb{R}^n$. Then the translation of Λ_0 by v

$$\Lambda = v + \Lambda_0$$

is called an **affine subspace** of $\mathbb{R}^n$. The representation above is clearly not unique since adding any member of Λ_0 to v does not change Λ . However, given

an affine subspace Λ we have a canonical choice for v as the closest point in Λ to the origin. This point exists and is unique since Λ is closed and convex. Furthermore the point v defined in this way must be orthogonal to any vector in the linear subspace Λ_0 . That is, $v \in \Lambda_0^\perp$, where $\Lambda_0^\perp$ is the linear subspace

$$\Lambda_0^\perp = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^n : \langle x, y \rangle = 0 \text{ for all } y \in \Lambda_0\}$$

also known as the **orthogonal complement** of Λ_0 . Thus we rephrase our definition as follows:

4.2.1 Definition. An **affine subspace** Λ of dimension d in $\mathbb{R}^n$ is defined uniquely by

$$\Lambda = v + \Lambda_0$$

where Λ_0 is a linear subspace of dimension d and $v \in \Lambda_0^\perp$. Sometimes we call Λ a “ d -plane”.

4.2.2 Remark. Note that the hyperplanes in the original definition of the RT are $(n - 1)$ -planes, and the lines in the “X-ray transform” are 1-planes.

Recall that if Λ_0 is a fixed linear subspace of dimension d , the orthogonal complements $\Lambda_0^\perp$ is a linear subspace of dimension $n - d$. For any $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$ there is a unique orthogonal decomposition $x = x_{\Lambda_0} + x_{\Lambda_0^\perp}$ where $x_{\Lambda_0} \in \Lambda_0$ and $x_{\Lambda_0^\perp} \in \Lambda_0^\perp$. This idea can be summarized by the expression

$$\mathbb{R}^n = \Lambda_0 \oplus \Lambda_0^\perp.$$

Sometimes it is convenient to have an explicit coordinate system on an affine subspace. If $u^{(1)}, \dots, u^{(d)}$ is an orthonormal basis for Λ_0 then there is an isometric embedding of $\mathbb{R}^d$ into $\mathbb{R}^n$ with image Λ given by $x(t) : \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow \Lambda$ where

$$x(t) = v + t_1 u^{(1)} + \dots + t_d u^{(d)}, \quad t \in \mathbb{R}^d.$$

By this embedding can define the Euclidean measure dx on Λ as the pushforward of the Lebesgue measure on $\mathbb{R}^n$, and the standard Gaussian weight on Λ as $w_d(t)$. Note the $x(t)$ is defined in such a way that $x(0) = v$ which is essential when defining the Gaussian measure on Λ .

Other times we prefer not to invoke a basis-dependent isometry, and while $x(t)$ clearly depends on the choice of $u^1, \dots, u^{(d)}$, we should note that both the Euclidean and Gaussian measures on Λ are invariant under orthogonal transformations about v and thus independent of basis.

Now we can define the natural analogue of the RT for affine subspaces, which is sometimes called the **d -plane transform**. To be consistent with the hyperplane RT we will write $v = p\omega$, where $\omega \in S^{n-1} \cap \Lambda_0^\perp$ and $p \in \mathbb{R}$. Of course this notation is unique only up to the identification $(\omega, p) = (-\omega, -p)$.

4.2.3 Definition. Let $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. For any affine subspace $\Lambda = p\omega + \Lambda_0$, we define the **Radon Transform of f on Λ** by

$$R_f(\Lambda) = \int_{\Lambda} f(x) \, dx,$$

and the **Gaussian Radon Transform of f on Λ** by

$$GR_f(\Lambda) = \int_{\Lambda} f(x) \gamma_d(x - p\omega) \, dx,$$

where d is the dimension of the linear subspace Λ_0 . In both definitions dx denotes the d -dimensional Lebesgue measure on Λ .

4.2.4 Remark. Explicitly, if $x(t) : \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow \Lambda$ is a Euclidean isometry then

$$R_f(\Lambda) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^d} f(x(t)) \, dt.$$

If furthermore $x(0) = p\omega$ then

$$GR_f(\Lambda) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^d} f(x(t)) \gamma(t) \, dt.$$

However keep in mind that these definitions are independent of the particular isometry.

In order to generalize the formula ^(eq:GRH)(4.1.1) we begin with the integral of H_{α} over linear subspaces. Recall that the GRT of a function f over a linear subspace Λ_0 can be written

$$GR_f(\Lambda_0) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^d \times \{0\}^{n-d}} f(Rx) \gamma_d(x) \, dx \quad (4.2.1) \quad \boxed{\text{eq:GRRot}}$$

where $R \in SO(n)$ is the a rotation sending $\mathbb{R}^d \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$ to Λ_0 . Thus we would like to investigate the action of rotations on certain functions of interest, namely monomials and Hermite polynomials.

4.2.5 Lemma. Let $f(x) = x^{\alpha}$ for some multi-index $\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n$ of degree $|\alpha| = k$. Then the rotation $f(Rx)$ has the expansion

$$f(Rx) = \sum_{\substack{\beta \in \mathbb{N}_0^n \\ |\beta|=k}} c(R)_{\beta}^{\alpha} x^{\beta}. \quad (4.2.2) \quad \boxed{\text{eq:monRot}}$$

The coefficients $c(R)_{\beta}^{\alpha}$ are given by

$$c(R)_{\beta}^{\alpha} = \sum_{i \in I(\beta)} \prod_{j=1}^n \langle Re_{i_j}, e_{\alpha_j} \rangle$$

where $\alpha^j = \ell$ if $0 < j - \alpha_1 - \dots - \alpha_{\ell-1} \leq \alpha_\ell$ and

$$I(\beta) = \{i \in \{1, \dots, n\}^k : 1, \dots, n \text{ have multiplicity } \beta_1, \dots, \beta_n \text{ in } i\}$$

Note that the inner products $\langle Re_{i_j}, e_{\alpha^j} \rangle$ are matrix entries for R .

Proof. First one should note that $(Rx)^\alpha$ is a homogeneous polynomial of degree k ; a polynomial because R is a linear transformation, and homogeneous because $R \in SO(n)$ so that for $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$,

$$(R\lambda x)^\alpha = (\lambda Rx)^\alpha = \lambda^k (Rx)^\alpha.$$

Using the tensor power notation from section ^{sec:tensors}1.8, we can write

$$(Rx)^\alpha = \prod_{i=1}^n \langle Rx, e_i \rangle^{\alpha_i} = \langle R^{\otimes k} x^{\otimes k}, \mathbf{e}^{\otimes \alpha} \rangle = \langle x^{\otimes k}, (R^{-1})^{\otimes k} \mathbf{e}^{\otimes \alpha} \rangle$$

Now we expand over the basis $\{\mathbf{e}_{\otimes i}\}_{i \in \{1, \dots, n\}^k}$, noting that each tuple $i \in \{1, \dots, n\}^k$ is an anagram to exactly one multiindex of degree k . To be precise $\{I(\beta)\}_{|\beta|=k}$ is a partition of $\{1, \dots, n\}^k$. Thus

$$\begin{aligned} \langle x^{\otimes k}, (R^{-1})^{\otimes k} \mathbf{e}^{\otimes \alpha} \rangle &= \sum_{\substack{\beta \in \mathbb{N}_0^n \\ |\beta|=k}} \sum_{i \in I(\beta)} \langle x^{\otimes k}, \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i} \rangle \langle \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i}, (R^{-1})^{\otimes k} \mathbf{e}^{\otimes \alpha} \rangle \\ &= \sum_{\substack{\beta \in \mathbb{N}_0^n \\ |\beta|=k}} x^\beta \sum_{i \in I(\beta)} \langle \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i}, (R^{-1})^{\otimes k} \mathbf{e}^{\otimes \alpha} \rangle. \end{aligned}$$

That we have the non-tensor expression

$$\langle \mathbf{e}_{\otimes i}, (R^{-1})^{\otimes k} \mathbf{e}^{\otimes \alpha} \rangle = \prod_{j=1}^n \langle e_{i_j}, R^{-1} e_{\alpha^j} \rangle = \prod_{j=1}^n \langle Re_{i_j}, e_{\alpha^j} \rangle$$

follows from the definition of the inner product on $(\mathbb{R}^n)^{\otimes k}$ and further notation from appendix A. $\square$

4.2.6 Remark. We could write the coefficient $c(R)_\beta^\alpha$ in a slightly different form. If we define the non-decreasing tuple $\tilde{\alpha}$ associated with a multi-index α by

$$\tilde{\alpha} = (\underbrace{1, \dots, 1}_{\alpha_1 \text{ times}}, \underbrace{2, \dots, 2}_{\alpha_2 \text{ times}}, \dots, \underbrace{n, \dots, n}_{\alpha_n \text{ times}})$$

then

$$c(R)_\beta^\alpha = \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} \prod_{j=1}^n R_{\sigma \tilde{\beta}_j, \tilde{\alpha}_j}.$$

4.2.7 Example. For a simple example take the monomial $f(x) = x_1^2 x_2$. Here $n = 2$, $\alpha = (2, 1)$ and $k = 3$. The partition of $\{1, 2\}^3$ over multi-indices $|(\beta_1, \beta_2)| = 3$

is given by

$$\begin{aligned}
I(3, 0) &= \{(1, 1, 1)\} \\
I(2, 1) &= \{(1, 1, 2), (1, 2, 1), (2, 1, 1)\} \\
I(1, 2) &= \{(1, 2, 2), (2, 1, 2), (2, 2, 1)\} \\
I(0, 3) &= \{(2, 2, 2)\}
\end{aligned}$$

Now note that $(\alpha^1, \alpha^2, \alpha^3) = (1, 1, 2)$. If $R \in SO(2)$ is a 2×2 rotation matrix with entries $R_{i,j} = \langle Re_i, e_j \rangle$ then the formula $\stackrel{\text{eq:monRot}}{(4.2.2)}$ says

$$\begin{aligned}
(Rx)^\alpha &= x_1^3 R_{1,1}^2 R_{1,2} \\
&\quad + x_1^2 x_2 (R_{1,1}^2 R_{2,2} + 2R_{1,1} R_{2,1} R_{1,2}) \\
&\quad + x_1 x_2^2 (2R_{1,1} R_{2,1} R_{2,2} + R_{2,1}^2 R_{1,2}) \\
&\quad + x_2^3 R_{2,1}^2 R_{2,2}
\end{aligned}$$

While tensor power notation is concise, this sort of representation is needed for computation.

4.2.8 Proposition. The GRT of a monomial $f(x) = x^\alpha$ on a linear subspace Λ_0 is given by

$$GR_f(\Lambda_0) = \sum_{\substack{\beta \in \mathbb{N}_0^n \\ |\beta|=k}} c(R)_\beta^\alpha c_\beta^G$$

where $c_\beta^G = \int_{\mathbb{R}^d} x^\beta \gamma_d(x) dx$ are the Gaussian moments on $\mathbb{R}^d$. **Should be indexed by only the first d entries of β ? Feels weird.**

Proof. We take $\stackrel{\text{eq:GRRot}}{(4.2.1)}$,

$$GR_f(\Lambda_0) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^d \times \{0\}^{n-d}} (Rx)^\alpha \gamma_d(x) dx,$$

and expand by $\stackrel{\text{eq:monRot}}{(4.2.2)}$,

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^d \times \{0\}^{n-d}} (Rx)^\alpha \gamma_d(x) dx = \sum_{\substack{\beta \in \mathbb{N}_0^n \\ |\beta|=k}} c(R)_\beta^\alpha \int_{\mathbb{R}^d \times \{0\}^{n-d}} x^\beta \gamma_d(x) dx$$

as needed. □

4.2.9 Proposition. The GRT of a multivariate Hermite polynomial H_α on an affine subspace Λ is given by

$$GR_{H_\alpha}(\Lambda) = \alpha! \sum_{\substack{\beta \in \mathbb{N}_0^n \\ |\beta|=|\alpha|}} c(P_{\Lambda_0^\perp})_\alpha^\beta \frac{H_\beta(p_0)}{\beta!}$$

Proof. Once again we take the GRT of the generating function $\phi(x) = e^{\langle x, y \rangle - \frac{\|y\|^2}{2}}$, initially expanding

$$GR_\phi(\Lambda) = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n} \frac{GR_{H_\alpha}(\Lambda)}{\alpha!} y^\alpha$$

Simultaneously we have

$$\begin{aligned} GR_\phi(\Lambda) &= e^{\langle p_0, y \rangle - \frac{\|y\|^2}{2}} (2\pi)^{-\frac{d}{2}} \int_{\Lambda} e^{\langle x, y \rangle - \frac{\|x\|^2}{2}} dx \\ &= e^{\langle p_0, y \rangle - \frac{\|y\|^2}{2} + \frac{\|P_{\Lambda_0} y\|^2}{2}} \\ &= e^{\langle p_0, y \rangle - \frac{\|P_{\Lambda_0^\perp} y\|^2}{2}} \\ &= \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n} \frac{H_\alpha(p_0)}{\alpha!} (P_{\Lambda_0^\perp} y)^\alpha \end{aligned}$$

Now we should have noted that the formula ^(eq:monRot)(4.2.2) applies not only to rotations but to any linear transformation, so we have

$$\begin{aligned} GR_\phi(\Lambda) &= \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n} \frac{H_\alpha(p_0)}{\alpha!} \sum_{\substack{\beta \in \mathbb{N}_0^n \\ |\beta| = |\alpha|}} c(P_{\Lambda_0^\perp})_\beta^\alpha y^\beta \\ &= \sum_{\beta \in \mathbb{N}_0^n} y^\beta \sum_{\substack{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}_0^n \\ |\alpha| = |\beta|}} c(P_{\Lambda_0^\perp})_\beta^\alpha \frac{H_\alpha(p_0)}{\alpha!} \end{aligned}$$

Comparing coefficients we conclude.

$$\frac{GR_{H_\alpha}(\Lambda)}{\alpha!} = \sum_{\substack{\beta \in \mathbb{N}_0^n \\ |\beta| = |\alpha|}} c(P_{\Lambda_0^\perp})_\alpha^\beta \frac{H_\beta(p_0)}{\beta!}$$

□

Chapter 5

Krawtchouk Polynomials and a Discrete GRT

Here we discuss discrete Radon transforms (DRTs) with the goal of developing a suitable discrete analogue to the Gaussian Radon transform (DGRT). Building on the formulas from the previous chapter we propose a DGRT defined via the Krawtchouk polynomials, which are discrete analogues to the Hermite polynomials.

5.1 Discrete Radon Transforms

Many discrete analogues to the classical transform have been proposed. In [Bey187](#), Beylkin proposes a DRT over a finite 2-dimensional lattice with an efficient inversion procedure. [Abou09](#) give a DRT over d -dimensional affine sublattices of $\mathbb{Z}^n$ as well as dual transforms, support and inversion theorems in analogue to the d -plane extended RT.

We argue that Beylkin's framework does not lend itself to the GRT setting because it lacks a distinguished origin point. Abouelaz et al.'s transform is a promising starting point for a DGRT worth investigating further. A key difference we should note is that the closest point of an affine sublattice to the origin does not in general coincide with the closest point of the corresponding affine subspace to the origin.

For now, we take a new DGRT following a somewhat roundabout path via the formulas of chapter 4.

5.2 Krawtchouk polynomials

The formula [eq:GRH](#) gives us a path toward defining a discrete analogue to the Gaussian Radon transform. We will begin introducing the centered binomial density and corresponding Krawtchouk polynomials by way of a classic model in probability.

Consider flipping a loaded coin with probability $p \in [0, 1]$ of landing on heads, and thus probability $(1 - p)$ of landing on tails. The probability of k heads in N

coin flips is given by the binomial probability density,

$$\binom{N}{k} p^k (1-p)^{N-k}$$

where $N \in \mathbb{N}_0$ and $k = 0, 1, \dots, N$. It is well known that the binomial distribution can be seen as a discrete analog to the Gaussian distribution. Thus we may expect that a discrete analog to the GRT may be defined via the binomial distribution.

In order to draw a clearer line between the binomial and Gaussian densities we make use of an alternate probabilistic model: the Bernoulli random walk. Picture a particle “walking” along the integer lattice $\mathbb{Z}$, beginning at the origin $x = 0$. At every step, we flip the loaded coin described above, stepping to the right if it lands on heads, and the left if tails. After N flips, the particle’s position is

$$x = (\# \text{ of heads}) - (\# \text{ of tails}) = k - (N - k) = 2k - N$$

Now the set of possible positions is $x \in [[N]] := \{-N, -N+2, \dots, N\}$, and the probability of each is precisely the probability of landing $k = \frac{N+x}{2}$ heads, that is,

$$\binom{N}{\frac{N+x}{2}} p^{\frac{N+x}{2}} (1-p)^{N-\frac{N+x}{2}} = \binom{N}{\frac{N+x}{2}} p^{\frac{N+x}{2}} (1-p)^{\frac{N-x}{2}}$$

We will define **centered binomial density** supported on $[[N]]$ by

$$B_N(x) = \binom{N}{\frac{N+x}{2}} p^{\frac{N+x}{2}} (1-p)^{\frac{N-x}{2}}.$$

Since the expected displacement at each (independent) step is $p - (1-p) = 2p - 1$, we calculate the expected position after N steps to be

$$E(B_N) = 2Np - N.$$

Furthermore the variance of each displacement step is $4p(1-p)$ so that the variance of B_N is

$$\text{Var}(B_N) = 4Np(1-p)$$

The earlier claim that the binomial density is a discrete analog to the Gaussian density can be made explicit by the following limit relation. Let

$$z = \frac{x - E(B_N)}{\sqrt{\text{Var}(B_N)}} = \frac{x - 2Np + N}{2\sqrt{Np(1-p)}}$$

so that z has mean 0 and variance 1 with respect to B_n . Equivalently we may set

$$x = z\sqrt{\text{Var}(B_N)} + E(B_N) = 2z\sqrt{Np(1-p)} + 2Np + N$$

Then we have

$$\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} B_N(x) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} e^{-\frac{z^2}{2}} = \gamma(z).$$

This limit is perhaps one of the simplest cases of the robust central limit theorem, but can be proven in a number of more elementary ways [CITATION NEEDED].

5.2.1 Remark. Under an analogous limit a random walk process x is transformed into a Brownian motion process z . [CITATION NEEDED]

Having justified the the centered binomial densities $B_N(x)$ as discrete analogs of the Gaussian $w(z)$, we would like to define a sequence of polynomials orthogonal with respect to $B_N(x)$, as the Hermite polynomials are to $w(z)$. For convenience we start with a generating function

5.2.2 Definition. The Krawtchouk polynomials $K_k^{N,p}(x)$ may be defined by the generating function

$$\sum_{k=0}^N K_k^{N,p}(x) y^k = (1+y)^{\frac{N+x}{2}} (1-y)^{\frac{N-x}{2}}$$

The polynomials $K_k^{N,p}(x)$ satisfy the orthogonality property

$$\sum_{x \in [N]} K_k^{N,p}(x) K_\ell^{N,p}(x) B_N(x) = 0, \quad k \neq \ell$$

and can be written explicitly as

$$K_k^{N,p}(x) = \binom{N}{k} {}_2F_1 \left[\begin{matrix} -k & (x-N)/2 \\ & -N \end{matrix}; 2 \right]$$

The Krawtchouk and Hermite polynomials are related by the same limiting process.

5.2.3 Proposition. With $x = 2z\sqrt{Np(1-p)} + 2Np + N$ we have the following limit relation:

$$\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} K_k^{N,p}(x) = H_k(z)$$

Proof. [PROOF NEEDED] □

Now heuristically we expect a formula analogous to (4.1.1) in the form

$$GR_{K_\alpha^{N,p}}(\omega, p) = K_k^{N,p}(p) \omega^\alpha, \quad |\alpha| = k$$

where

$$K_{\alpha}^{N,p}(x) = \prod_{i=1}^n K_{\alpha_i}^{N,p}(x_i)$$

We should resolve the conflicting variables both named p , perhaps the Krawtchouk p ought to be a q or isn't necessary in the first place.

The desired formula would represent a discrete analog for the Gaussian Radon transform on the finite cubic lattice $[[N]]^n$, however it is not yet clear how to interpret this. An immediate concern is that the cubic lattice does not admit “hyperplanes” for arbitrary p and ω . Indeed in the worst case, if ω is not rational (that is the ratios between coordinates of ω are not rational, or equivalently the hyperspherical coordinates of ω include an angle which is an irrational multiple of π) then a hyperplane orthogonal can contain at most one lattice point. In the case when ω is rational — in the sense above — we may restrict p to the projection of the lattice onto the span of ω , and sum over the lattice hyperplane $\langle x, \omega \rangle = p$ with respect to the binomial weight centered on $p\omega$. It remains to be seen whether such an interpretation agrees with the heuristic formula above.

Take the symmetric random walk, where the coin is fair ($p = 1 - p = \frac{1}{2}$). The position after N flips has distribution

$$B_N(x) = \frac{1}{2^N} \binom{N}{\frac{N+x}{2}}, \quad x \in [[N]]$$

with expected value $E(B_N) = 0$ and variance $Var(B_N) = N$. The limiting process is then given by $B_N(x) \rightarrow w(z)$ where

$$z = \frac{x}{\sqrt{N}}$$

and further $K_k^{N, \frac{1}{2}}(x) \rightarrow H_k(z)$.

Now consider the following scenario in two dimensions. A particle starting at the origin $x = (x_1, x_2) = 0$ flips two fair coins, stepping down/up depending on the first coin, left/right depending on the second. This means the particle moves one unit up and right, up and left, down and right, or down and left, with equal probability.

5.3 The proposed discrete GRT

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